Government-documented gaps in federal contract data (version 3)

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What GAO, inspectors general, Treasury and USAspending, GSA, OMB, the FAR Council and CRS have documented about gaps and errors in federal contract data, and what each gap means for HHI and top-4 share per awarding agency, product or service code and fiscal year, FY2008 to FY2025.

Summary

Our project measures how concentrated federal contracting is, using HHI and the top-4 share within each awarding agency, product or service code and fiscal year. Those numbers can only be as good as the contract data behind them. So we searched what the government itself has written about gaps and errors in that data. The search found 280 findings in 202 sources, and 198 of those sources were read in the original.

Missing dollars turn out to be the smaller worry. Wherever the government tested them, obligation amounts and the awarding agency were among the most accurate fields in the data. The larger risks sit in the other two parts of our measure. Product codes changed meaning at two points in our window, so one code can name a different market before and after. The vendor field is the least checked field we rely on. No agency is responsible for parent IDs, and some records name a middleman or a placeholder as the vendor.

Some spending never enters the data by rule. Other transaction agreements (OTAs) run about $16 billion to $18 billion a year in recent years, and classified actions, most purchase card buys and buyers outside the FAR are absent too. These gaps define the scope of what our measure describes, and the final report should say so plainly.

Government testing of contract records is thin and uneven. Six of our 18 years had no test by GAO or an inspector general of contract records against contract files or agency records. Those years are FY2013 to FY2015 and FY2022 to FY2024. FY2013 to FY2015 also have no published total to check our data against, which makes them our least verified years.

Each finding has an ID such as E02. The appendix lists all 280 findings by topic, each with its source, page and period. `config/gov_findings.csv` also holds each finding's verbatim quote.

What matters most for our measure

Five issues stand out. They are ordered by how directly each one can move HHI and the top-4 share.

1. Product codes change meaning at two points

The product or service code (PSC) is one of the three parts of every cell. GSA renumbered large parts of the code list twice during our window.

The first change took effect on October 1, 2011, the first day of FY2012. GSA renumbered the codes for facility-based services. 384 ended codes were replaced by 504 new ones, and combined codes were split. The old code Z111, for maintenance, repair or alteration of office buildings, became two codes, Z1AA for maintenance and Z2AA for repair or alteration (E03, E04).

The second change came on October 30, 2020, one month into FY2021. GSA ended 721 research and development codes and started 155 new ones aligned to budget functions. It replaced the IT codes with a new scheme on the same day (E01, E06). 139 of the 155 new R&D codes reuse an old code string with a new meaning.

AC11 meant defense aircraft basic research until October 29, 2020. From the next day it means all Department of Defense military basic research (E02).

Old rows keep the code that was valid when they were reported, and FPDS does not convert them (E05). GSA also says FPDS cannot update a code on an existing contract to the current list (D01). Smaller revisions followed in 2015, 2019, 2020, 2022, 2024 and 2025 (E33, E34).

What it does to the measure. Cells keyed on these codes break at FY2012 and FY2021. A split leaves fewer vendors and dollars in each new cell, so HHI can rise by construction. A reused string such as AC11 suddenly covers a much wider market, so HHI can fall with no change in competition. The team needs to choose how to handle these breaks before building trends. The choices are to compare trends only within each code era, to roll the affected codes up to a level that stayed the same, or to build a crosswalk from GSA's code list.

2. The vendor field is the least checked

Our vendor is the parent UEI on each row. The government does not check that field. OMB guidance says agencies are not responsible for parent information, because it comes from the recipient's own registration in SAM (D04, D05).

The evidence on how often parent IDs are wrong is mixed, and the strongest-sounding figure is the weakest.

- **DoD, FY2017 Q2.** DoD's inspector general found the parent ID "inaccurate or unsupported" in all 57 sampled procurement transactions (D06). The same table also shows the country code, congressional district, address and type of transaction failing in all 57. The table combines inaccurate values with missing support, and its footnote says the parent ID is generated by FPDS. A failure that uniform points to a systemic problem in the first DATA Act quarter, or to missing paperwork. It is weak evidence that the parent values themselves were wrong.
- **FY2019 Q1.** Five inspectors general reported completeness error rates above 20% for the parent ID, and 13 reported none (D07).
- **FY2020 to FY2021.** Sixteen inspectors general reported parent ID errors and 22 reported parent name errors, which they traced to shared systems such as SAM and FPDS (D08, D09). At NASA, 62 of 242 tested transactions had a wrong parent name or ID. Officials explained that a parent change made in SAM does not flow to FPDS automatically (D10).
- **DoD, FY2020 Q4.** The parent ID had an accuracy error rate of 1.3%, against 11.0% for the parent name (D11). The ID is far more reliable than the name, which supports keying our vendors on the ID.

Our own parent test points the same way. In four corporate deals from 2013 to 2020, the parent ID switched 2 to 6 months after each deal closed. A lag of that size fits NASA's explanation that SAM updates reach FPDS late.

Two other problems put the wrong company in the vendor field.

- **Middlemen on consortium awards.** Many DoD and HHS other transaction agreements go through a consortium manager, which passes the money to member firms. FPDS records the manager as the vendor. One manager was credited with $7.2 billion in COVID-19 OTAs and passed nearly all of it to five drug companies (D19, D20, D21). Even after FPDS added consortium fields in 2022, 395 of 2,431 records in FY2023 and FY2024 still named the manager as the firm doing the work (D22). Most OTAs sit outside our data. HHS, however, filed COVID-19 OTAs as contracts and overstated its contracts by $1.55 billion (D18), so some of these rows are probably in our FY2020 and FY2021 cells.
- **Placeholder vendors.** The rules allow generic vendor IDs. DoD's list includes MISCELLANEOUS FOREIGN AWARDEES and an ID for consolidated purchase card reports (D14, D15, D16). A consolidated report can sum many actions in one row (D17).

What it does to the measure. Parent errors can split one firm into several vendors or merge separate firms, so HHI can move in either direction. Middlemen and placeholders pool many firms under one ID, which inflates HHI and the top-4 share in the cells they touch.

3. Some spending never enters the data

The FAR defines which contract actions go into FPDS, and several kinds of spending fall outside it by rule.

- **Other transaction agreements.** OTAs are not FAR contracts, so they are not contract actions (A14). GAO reports them separately from contract spending, at $16.5 billion in FY2020, nearly $16 billion in FY2023, $18.4 billion in FY2024 and $18.2 billion in FY2025 (A01). DoD's OTA spending grew from $1.8 billion in FY2016 to over $18 billion in FY2024. DoD obligated $62.9 billion on OTAs in FY2021 to FY2024, and 10 vendors received about 57% of it (A02). DoD reports prototype and production OTAs in a separate FPDS module and research OTAs not at all (A04). GAO found over $40 billion in OTAs from FY2020 to FY2022 that never reached USAspending (A03).
- **Classified actions.** The FAR bars reporting any action whose data would be classified, or that would compromise national security (A06, A07, A08). No size is published.
- **Small purchases.** Agencies must report actions above the micro-purchase threshold (A09). Below it, reporting is optional and needs written approval (A27). Purchase card buys below the threshold are barred unless an agency's own procedures call for them, and DoD tells its offices not to report them (A11, A12). Purchase card spending was $19.5 billion in FY2011 (F16).
- **Other channels.** GSA stock orders, AbilityOne store purchases, resale, concessions, training and interagency agreements are excluded. Actions paid with non-appropriated funds are left out unless the FPDS office approves (A13, A18 to A22).
- **Buyers outside FPDS.** FPDS holds no data from the legislative or judicial branches, the CIA, the NSA or certain DoD components (B04). In FY2012, the FDIC, NCUA and TVA also reported no contracts, citing non-appropriated funds (B03).

Two documented gaps sound larger than they are for our data. In FY2022, 49 of 152 agencies reported nothing to USAspending. The 25 executive branch agencies among them held just over $5 billion of $6 trillion in net outlays, under 0.1% (B05). Contract rows also reach USAspending straight from FPDS, so an agency that skips its account files can still appear in our data. Separately, GAO said in 2009 that it could not rely on FPDS alone for contracting in Iraq and Afghanistan, because not all actions were entered (B07). That gap could touch our earliest years.

What it does to the measure. These gaps set the scope. Our HHI describes reported, unclassified FAR contracts above the micro-purchase threshold. For most cells the missing dollars are small. Two areas are exceptions. DoD research and prototype markets lose a growing share of their spending to OTAs, which grew about tenfold from FY2016 to FY2024, and that OTA money is itself concentrated. Classified buying is missing at an unknown size.

4. The awarding agency can move without any change in buying

Our cells use the awarding agency, the office that signs the contract. Some agencies buy for others, and the dollars land in the cells of the agency that signed.

- **Buying through GSA.** In FY2024, $78.2 billion went through GSA contract vehicles, and GSA itself awarded $16.3 billion on behalf of other agencies (G02). Executive Order 14240 of March 20, 2025 directs agencies to have GSA buy common goods and services, about $490 billion a year (G01). GSA set up an office to take over contracts from other agencies (G03).
- **Shared service providers.** Some small agencies buy through a provider, so their contracts appear under the provider's agency code (B01, B02).

- **Reorganizations.** USAspending stopped grouping Army Corps of Engineers civil works under DoD on October 21, 2019 (E13). Background investigations moved from OPM to DoD by September 30, 2019 (E15). USAID's work began moving to State in 2025 (E14).

What it does to the measure. Agency cells shrink or grow with no change in what the government needs. Trends break at FY2020 for background investigations and at FY2025 for buying moved to GSA. The funding agency, which records who paid, can test this from FY2011 on. Earlier years carry a placeholder funding code.

5. Data quality differs by year, and fewer people check it now

The government says quality has improved over time. USAspending warns that more recent fiscal years tend to have higher quality data (E08). GAO faulted Treasury for not telling users that quality varies across FY2008 to FY2021 (E07). GAO's strictest test asks whether every tested field on a record matches the agency's own records. Only 2% to 7% of awards passed in FY2012 (D25), 0% to 1% in FY2017 Q2 (D26) and 24% to 34% in FY2018 Q4 (D27). One wrong field fails the whole record, so these rates are much lower than the accuracy of any single field.

Oversight has thinned since FY2021. The law requiring inspectors general to test agency data expired in 2021, and their last reports came out in November 2021 (F09, F10). The last governmentwide FPDS quality summary covers FY2019 (F07, F08). For FY2023, none of the 24 CFO Act agencies' quality reports met all of OMB's rules, and 19 of the 24 were late (F05). Only 36 of the 70 agencies that reported to FPDS confirmed completing a quality report. The other 34 held almost $2 billion, about 0.26% of contract obligations (F06). GSA paused modernization of its award systems in September 2023, facing a funding gap of nearly $100 million that year, and had put plans for FPDS on hold by May 2025 (F04, G17).

What it does to the measure. A rising or falling HHI trend can partly reflect better coding in later years. Error rates for FY2022 to FY2025 are simply unknown.

What matters less

Several documented problems turn out to be minor for our measure, or already handled.

- **Late reporting.** DoD and Army Corps of Engineers data are held for 90 days before release (C06, C09). Our release came 11 months after FY2025 closed, so the hold cuts nothing.
- **Changes after the fact.** FPDS has no cut-off for corrections, and agencies can amend old contracts (C01, C03). Our results therefore belong to the 2026-09-06 release, which the pipeline records.
- **Competition fields.** GAO's samples found 18% to 54% of competition codes wrong (D60 to D65). That leaves HHI untouched, but any analysis that pairs concentration with competition inherits the error.
- **Terminations.** Several thousand USAID terminations were never entered in FPDS, so USAID's FY2025 totals are too high (G04). FPDS also cannot tell a complete termination from a partial one (G11, G12). Terminations also feed the negative vendor totals that the integrity report counts.

Reference tables

How accurate each field is

The table pulls together every test of the fields our measure uses. Agencies' own samples tend to show high accuracy. Outside tests by GAO and inspectors general show lower rates and cover fewer years.

Field	What tests found	Years tested	Findings
Obligation amount	Consistent with agency records in 84% to 92% of awards in FY2017 Q2 and 91% to 97% in FY2018 Q4. Agencies' own samples matched 97.5% to 99.7%. DoD's sample error rate was 3.0% in FY2020 Q4.	FY2014 to FY2020	D03, D28, D29, D45
Awarding agency	98% to 100% consistent in FY2018 Q4, and the only award field significantly consistent in FY2017 Q2.	FY2017 to FY2018	D28, D29
Product or service code	No test by GAO or an inspector general. Agencies' own samples matched 98.5% to 99.4%. FPDS cannot update a code to the current list, and one code per contract hides mixed purchases.	FY2014 to FY2023	D01, D02, D03
Vendor ID	Agencies' own samples matched the DUNS number 98.6% to 99.8%.	FY2014 to FY2019	D03
Parent ID	No agency is responsible for it. Results range from a 1.3% accuracy error at DoD in FY2020 Q4 to 62 of 242 NASA transactions with a wrong parent name or ID.	FY2017 to FY2021	D04 to D11
Parent name	DoD's accuracy error rose from 0.5% in FY2019 Q1 to 11.0% in FY2020 Q4. 22 inspectors general reported errors traced to shared systems.	FY2019 to FY2021	D08, D11
NAICS	68% to 85% consistent in FY2017 Q2. In FY2018 Q4, 23% to 38% of procurement records were inconsistent.	FY2017 to FY2018	D28, D29
Competition codes	18% to 54% of sampled records miscoded across GAO's samples.	FY2008 to FY2016	D60 to D65
Contract value fields	Current total value 33% to 52% consistent in FY2017 Q2. Several inspectors general reported known calculation issues in FPDS.	FY2017 to FY2021	D29, D54 to D56

When the rules and codes changed

Each of these dates can create a step in our data with no change in actual buying.

Date	Change	Effect on our data	Findings
2007-10-01, then every 5 years	NAICS revisions adopted at the start of FY2008, FY2013, FY2018 and FY2023	Industry codes break at each revision	E35, E36
2008-04-22	FAR reporting rules rewritten in mid-FY2008, making small actions optional with a call to the FPDS office	Row counts can step in FY2008	E19, E20
2011-01-31	A duty to report every award in certain small business industries ends	Small rows can drop	E21, E22
2011-09-20	DoD requires card buys under contracts to be reported regardless of value	Small DoD rows can rise from FY2012	E23
2011-10-01	Facility service codes renumbered and split, at the start of FY2012	Product code cells break	E03, E04
2012-12-20	Resale, concessions, training, interagency agreements and A-76 letters move from optional to barred, and generic vendor IDs are limited	Rows in those categories end	E26, E27, D14
2015-10-01	New medical service codes and product class updates	Small product code changes	E33
2019-06-29	DoD starts reporting production OTAs in FPDS's separate OTA module	Outside our contract rows	E17
2019-10-21	USAspending stops grouping Army Corps of Engineers civil works under DoD	Agency grouping changes	E13
2019-10-25	Performance start dates carry over from the base award to every modification	Date fields change	E39
2020-10-30	R&D and IT codes replaced, with 139 R&D code strings reused	Product code cells break in FY2021	E01, E02, E06
2022-04-04	DUNS retired and the UEI becomes the vendor key	Vendor IDs before 2022 were filled in afterwards	E09, E10

Date	Change	Effect on our data	Findings
2025-03-20	Executive Order 14240 moves common buying to GSA	Agency cells shift from FY2025	G01
2026-02-24	SAM.gov replaces FPDS as the repository for contract data	Later releases may differ for the same years	G05, G06, G07

Which years the government tested

A record test is one by GAO or an inspector general that checks contract records against contract files or agency records. Other reviews tested the data electronically, summarized agencies' own checks or reviewed procedures. FY2017 to FY2021 were each tested for one quarter only.

FY	Record tests of contract rows	Other reviews of the data	Coverage
2008	GAO competition coding for 107 contracts and orders, at locations chosen on FY2008 obligations (GAO-10-833). GAO's 2010 review of 100 awards, cited in GAO-14-476. GAO's check of 8(a) contract values (GAO-13-118).	OFPP review of agencies' FY2008 quality plans (OFPP-2009-10-07)	Tested
2009	GAO's check of 21 large 8(a) contracts against contract files, FY2008 to FY2012 Q2 (GAO-13-118)	GAO competition trend data (GAO-10-833)	Narrow
2010	Same as FY2009	GAO urgency trend data (GAO-14-304). GAO count of OTAs from agency systems (GAO-16-209).	Narrow
2011	GAO one-offer sample (GAO-13-325). GAO urgency sample (GAO-14-304).	GAO electronic tests (GAO-12-873, GAO-17-244SP)	Tested
2012	GAO sample of 385 awards, 153 of them contracts (GAO-14-476). GAO-13-325 and GAO-14-304 samples.	GAO electronic tests (GAO-17-244SP)	Tested
2013	None	GAO electronic tests (GAO-17-244SP). CRS review of OT records (CRS-R45521).	None
2014	None	GAO electronic tests (GAO-17-244SP). Agencies' own samples (FPDS-DQ-SUMMARY-FY2019).	None
2015	None	GAO electronic tests (GAO-17-244SP). Agencies' own samples. CRS review of OT records.	None
2016	GAO sample of 171 IT contracts and orders (GAO-19-63)	GAO electronic tests of OT records (GAO-20-84). Agencies' own samples.	Tested
2017	GAO sample of 402 records, Q2 (GAO-18-138). 53 inspector general audits of Q2 (GAO-18-546), including DoD (DODIG-2018-020).	Agencies' own samples. GAO-20-84.	One quarter
2018	GAO sample of 405 records, Q4 (GAO-20-75)	Agencies' own samples. GAO-20-84.	One quarter
2019	51 inspector general audits of Q1 (GAO-20-540), including DoD (DODIG-2020-010)	Agencies' own samples. GAO review of OTA data (GAO-22-105357).	One quarter
2020	Inspector general audits of one quarter each (GAO-22-105427). DoD, DHS, NASA and VA tested Q4.	GAO COVID-19 reviews (GAO-20-632, GAO-21-501, GAO-21-387)	One quarter
2021	Inspector general audits of Q1 or Q2 (GAO-22-105427), including DOE, GSA and HHS	GAO review of Treasury processes (GAO-22-104702). Agency-reported accuracy (GAO-25-107469).	One quarter
2022	None	Agency-reported accuracy (GAO-25-107469). GAO review of who reports (GAO-24-106214).	None

FY	Record tests of contract rows	Other reviews of the data	Coverage
2023	None for contract rows. GAO checked consortium fields on OTA records (GAO-25-107546).	GAO review of agency quality reports (GAO-25-107469). GAO match of recipient IDs to SAM (GAO-26-107466).	None
2024	None for contract rows. GAO-25-107546 for OTA records.	GAO match of recipient IDs to SAM (GAO-26-107466)	None
2025	Terminated contracts only. USDA's inspector general checked 792 against FPDS and USDA systems (USDA-OIG-50601-0012-31).	GAO links of terminations to FPDS (GAO-26-108615, GAO-26-109096). VA's inspector general reviewed termination lists (VAOIG-25-03033-230).	Partial

Checks we could run in our data

None of these has been run. Each names the columns it would use. The first five matter most, because they test the issues that can move HHI.

1. **Product code breaks.** Count distinct `product_or_service_code` values by fiscal year. List the codes that start or end in FY2012 and FY2021. For each reused R&D code string, compare dollars and vendor counts in FY2020 and FY2022.
2. **Consortium managers as vendors.** Sum DoD and HHS cell dollars for the consortium management organizations GAO names, by `recipient_name` and `recipient_uei`.
3. **Generic vendor IDs.** Sum rows and dollars for the generic IDs on DoD's list (`LN9PU5M2YZN5`, `R5NWZ87HPLX4` and `U9X7H1UVY6U5`) by year and cell, from `recipient_uei` and `recipient_parent_uei`.
4. **Parent ID stability.** For each `recipient_uei`, count distinct `recipient_parent_uei` values within each fiscal year, and list vendors whose parent changes mid-year.
5. **Buying for other agencies.** Compare `awarding_agency_code` with `funding_agency_code` by year to size assisted buying. Track GSA's share of awarding dollars in FY2024 and FY2025, USAID (072) and State (019) in FY2024 and FY2025, and OPM (024) investigation codes in FY2019 to FY2021.
6. **OTA rows.** Search `transaction_description` and `award_description` for other transaction wording, and list HHS rows in FY2020 and FY2021 that match GAO's COVID-19 OTA awards by `recipient_name` and dollars.
7. **Vendor IDs across April 2022.** For awards with actions in both FY2021 and FY2023, count those whose `recipient_uei` changed between the two years.
8. **Consolidated reports.** Compare the sum of `number_of_actions` with the row count by year and agency.
9. **Small rows and rule changes.** Count rows at or below the micro-purchase threshold by agency and month around April 2008, January 2011, September 2011 and December 2012, and for FY2014 to FY2015 and FY2018 to FY2019.
10. **Terminations.** Sum `federal_action_obligation` on rows with `action_type_code` E, F, N or X by agency and fiscal year, FY2024 and FY2025, and count the negative vendor totals they explain. Check USAID FY2025 awards for missing termination rows.
11. **Agencies present.** List the awarding agency codes present each year and compare them with USAspending's list of non-reporting entities and the agencies GAO named.
12. **DoD's 90-day hold.** Compare FY2025 DoD rows by `action_date` month with FY2024 to confirm the hold did not cut late FY2025.
13. **A later release.** Recompute Stage 1 totals on a later Award Data Archive release and compare cell totals by year, to size revisions and any effect of the SAM.gov switch.
14. **Thin cells.** Count cells with fewer than five vendors and their share of dollars, to judge how many cells a 1% product code error could change.

15. **COVID-19 sensitivity.** Recompute HHI for FY2020 to FY2022 with and without rows carrying the COVID-19 national interest action code, and again with the COVID-19 disaster fund codes, and report the range.

What we could not confirm

Each item was searched for in sources we could open. None is used as a finding.

- **Inspectors general found 16 of 41 agencies complete and 11 of 41 accurate for FY2017 Q2.** No government source we opened gives these counts. GAO-18-546 counts 53 inspector general reports and says 15 of 53 found data generally complete, timely, accurate or of quality. The 41 appears to be POGO's own tally.
- **A statute or FAR clause behind DoD's 90-day hold.** The only written authority found is DFARS PGI 204.604(2), which is guidance and first appears in its 2016 revision, plus an undated FPDS page.
- **Whether OTA records from FPDS's separate module appear in File D1 and the Award Data Archive.** No GAO, Treasury or GSA source says.
- **Which agencies make up GAO's $40 billion of unreported OTAs, and which of the 49 non-reporting agencies report contracts to FPDS.** GAO-24-106214 names none of them.
- **Any agency change in micro-purchase reporting practice in FY2015 or FY2019.** No OMB, GSA, DoD or CRS document records one.
- **Whether the purchase card data GSA gives FPDS become contract rows.** The FAR says the data serve reports only.
- **A GAO or inspector general statistical test of the product code field.** None of the reports we read tested it.
- **Why DoD's links between awards and accounts fell in FY2024 and FY2025.** No Treasury, USAspending or DoD note explains it.
- **That the fall 2025 lapse in appropriations delayed FPDS, SAM.gov or USAspending updates.** No government source says so.
- **How FPDS treats an ended product code on a modification to an older award.** No document found says.
- **Which awarding agency code FPDS uses for USAID awards moved to State, and for OPM investigation contracts moved to DoD.** No government source ties either move to agency codes.
- **Error rates for set-aside and size fields from a sample of prime contract files.** No such GAO sample covers FY2008 to FY2025.
- **Other items.** Version 1 lists 13 more, mostly sources that were blocked or sat outside the allowed sites.

Appendix A. Every gap at a glance

One row per gap. Status says whether our pipeline already handles the gap, whether our data can test it, or whether we can only state it as a limit.

Gap	Size where known	Effect on HHI and top-4 share	Status	Findings
OTAs outside contract data	GAO counts $16.5 billion in FY2020, nearly $16 billion in FY2023 and $18.2 billion in FY2025. DoD alone obligated $62.9 billion in FY2021 to FY2024.	R&D and prototype cells miss a growing part of their market, more from FY2019 on.	Can test whether any OTA rows are present	A01 to A05, A31, B06, E17, E18
Pass-through and consortium vendors	One manager took $7.2 billion in COVID-19 OTAs and passed nearly all of it to five firms. 395 of 2,431 OTA records still named the manager in FY2023 to FY2024. HHS filed $1.55 billion of OTAs as contracts.	A manager counted as the vendor raises both measures in any cell that holds such awards. The HHS rows are probably in our FY2020 and FY2021 data.	Can test	D18 to D22, D69

Gap	Size where known	Effect on HHI and top-4 share	Status	Findings
Classified and national security actions	No size published	DoD and intelligence cells miss vendors with no marker. The bias can go either way.	Limit only	A06 to A08, F13
Purchase cards and buys at or below the micro-purchase threshold	Card spending was $19.5 billion in FY2011.	Few dollars per cell, so both measures barely move. Action counts move a lot.	Partly handled. The integrity report proposes counting only actions of $10,000 or more.	A09 to A12, A23 to A30, F16
Buyers outside the FAR or outside FPDS	CIA, NSA, FDIC, NCUA, TVA and the legislative and judicial branches. 49 of 152 agencies reported nothing to USAspending in FY2022.	These buyers have no cells. Market totals for common products are too small.	Can list the agency codes present. Otherwise a limit.	A13, A14, A17, B03 to B05, B10, B11
Other channels kept out by rule	GSA stock, AbilityOne stores, resale, interagency agreements and non-appropriated funds. No size published.	Demand for common supplies shows up under GSA or not at all.	Limit only	A18 to A22, E26, E27
Product codes recoded	In FY2012, 504 new facility service codes replaced 384. On October 30, 2020, 721 R&D codes ended and 155 began, with 139 reused strings. IT codes were replaced the same day.	Cells keyed on these codes break at FY2012 and FY2021. A reused code such as AC11 widens with no warning, so HHI can move with no change in the market.	Can test. Must be handled before Stage 3.	E01 to E06, E33, E34
Product code accuracy	Agency samples matched the code to contract files 98.5% to 99.4% of the time, FY2014 to FY2019. Each contract carries one code by rule. GSA says FPDS cannot update a code to the current list.	About 1% of dollars may sit in the wrong cell. Thin cells and mixed contracts are most exposed.	Can test how many cells are thin. Otherwise a limit.	D01 to D03
Parent ID errors	DoD's FY2017 Q2 sample failed the parent ID on all 57 transactions, a result shared with several other fields in that first quarter. Five inspectors general found parent ID completeness errors above 20% in FY2019 Q1. At NASA, 62 of 242 transactions had a wrong parent in FY2020 Q4.	Errors split one firm into several vendors or merge separate firms. Either direction is possible.	Partly handled by the parent test in the integrity report. Can test more.	D04 to D13, E09 to E12
Generic vendor IDs	DoD allows generic IDs, including MISCELLANEOUS FOREIGN AWARDEES and two for purchase card reports.	Many vendors pooled under one ID act as one large vendor and raise both measures.	Partly handled by a proposed team decision. Can test the card IDs.	D14 to D17
Buying done by one agency for another	GSA awarded $16.3 billion for other agencies in FY2024.	Dollars land in the awarding agency's cells, which merges different buyers' markets.	Can test with the funding agency	B01, B02, D23, E16, G02
Agency reorganizations and the 2025 shift to GSA	Executive Order 14240 covers about $490 billion a year of common goods and services. USAID work moved toward State in FY2025.	Agency cells shrink or grow with no change in demand. Trends break at FY2020 for background investigations and at FY2025.	Can test	E13 to E15, G01 to G03, G15
Reporting rule changes	A rule rewrite in April 2008, the end of a reporting duty in FY2011, DoD card orders from FY2012 and new exclusions from December 2012.	Row counts break in those years. Dollar shares move little.	Can test	E19 to E27

Gap	Size where known	Effect on HHI and top-4 share	Status	Findings
Late entry and DoD's 90-day hold	DoD data are held 90 days. DoD's File D1 timeliness error rate was 21.0% in FY2019 Q1.	Matters only for an extract taken soon after a year ends. Our release came 11 months after FY2025 closed.	Already handled	C06 to C23
Revisions after the fact	No cut-off for changes. Agencies can amend contracts back to 1980. A new SAM.gov feed adds deleted contracts.	Any year can change between releases, so our results belong to the 2026-09-06 release.	Already handled by pinning the release. Can test against a later one.	C01, C03, C04, G06
Deobligations and terminations	DHS deobligated a net $92 million on 438 terminated contracts. Several thousand USAID terminations were never entered. FPDS does not tell complete terminations from partial ones.	Negative vendor totals, and USAID FY2025 totals that are too high. Settlement money lands in later years.	Partly handled by a proposed team decision. Can test.	C02, D59, G04, G11 to G14, G21 to G23, G30 to G32
Consolidated reports	One row can hold many actions.	Row counts understate actions. Dollars are unaffected.	Can test with the number of actions	A29, D16, D17, F30
Competition and offers fields	18% to 54% of sampled records were miscoded in GAO's samples.	No effect on HHI or top-4 share. Any side analysis that pairs concentration with competition inherits the error.	Limit only	D60 to D67, E28, E29
Quality that changes across years	The share of award records fully consistent with agency records was 2% to 7% in FY2012, 0% to 1% in FY2017 Q2 and 24% to 34% in FY2018 Q4.	Trends in HHI can partly reflect better coding in later years.	Limit only	D25 to D27, E07, E08
Thin oversight in recent years	No mandated inspector general test after FY2021 Q2. No governmentwide FPDS quality summary after FY2019. None of the 24 CFO Act agencies' FY2023 quality reports met OMB's rules.	Error rates for FY2022 to FY2025 are unknown.	Limit only	F04 to F10, G17
The move from FPDS to SAM.gov	SAM.gov replaced FPDS on February 24, 2026. A new contract loader is coming to the Broker.	Our release was built after the switch. Later releases may differ for the same years.	Can test against a later release	G05 to G10
Links between awards and agency accounts	DoD's linked contract awards fell from 554,163 in FY2023 to 25,729 in FY2025. State shows 80,177 account-side contract awards with no FPDS record in FY2025.	No effect on the FPDS rows we hold. State's unmatched awards may be spending missing from our data, size unknown.	Counts only. Dollars would need the account files.	F12, F17 to F20, G16

Appendix B. All findings by topic

Every finding appears here once, grouped by the topics of this note in place of version 1's lettered groups. Each entry gives what the source says, then the source and page, the period it covers and its effect on our measure. Effect labels are scope (the gap sets what the data covers), bias risk (it can move HHI or the top-4 share), timing, counts only, small, already handled or unknown.

Topic 1. Product and industry codes

How the product or service code and the NAICS code were defined, revised and checked. This topic holds 15 findings.

Product code revisions. GSA renumbered the codes in FY2012 and FY2021 and made smaller changes in between.

- **E01.** GSA restructured all R&D PSCs in the October 2020 revision. It end-dated 721 R&D codes on October 29, 2020 and activated 155 new R&D codes on October 30, 2020, aligned to OMB budget functions. *Source PSC-Manual-October-2020, Section V.C, Research and Development Code Summary item 3, p. 5 (PDF p. 8). Period covered is Change on October 30, 2020 (FY2021, about one month into the fiscal year). Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **E02.** The new R&D codes reuse many old code strings with a different meaning. AC11 meant defense aircraft basic research until October 29, 2020 and means all Department of Defense military basic research from October 30, 2020. *Source PSC-Manual-October-2020, Appendix 1, Research and Development Codes END-DATED (October 2020), p. 187 (PDF p. 190). Period covered is FY2008 to FY2020 versus FY2021 to FY2025. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **E03.** The PSC Manual revision effective October 1, 2011 (start of FY2012) renumbered the facility-based service codes. GSA reports 384 ended service codes replaced by 504 new codes, 30 new service codes, 12 service codes ended by merging into existing codes, and 39 product codes ended. *Source PSC-Manual-August-2011, Section V.A, Summary of Changes to PSC Codes, p. 9 (PDF p. 10). Period covered is Effective FY2012 (October 1, 2011). Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **E04.** The 2011 revision split the old combined maintenance, repair and alteration codes into two codes. Code Z111 for office buildings became Z1AA (maintenance) and Z2AA (repair or alteration). *Source PSC-Manual-August-2011, Section V.D, Services Code Summary item 2, p. 11 (PDF p. 12). Period covered is Effective FY2012 (October 1, 2011). Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **E05.** End-dated PSCs cannot be chosen for new reports in FPDS, but rows already reported keep the old code. Historical rows in our data therefore carry whatever code was valid when they were reported. *Source PSC-Manual-August-2011, Section V.B, General Comments item 6, p. 10 (PDF p. 11). Period covered is FY2008 to FY2025. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **E06.** The same October 2020 revision replaced the IT codes with a new schema. GSA end-dated 40 IT service codes and 30 IT product codes and activated 23 IT service codes and 17 IT product codes. *Source PSC-Manual-October-2020, Section V.D, Services Code Summary item 2, p. 5 (PDF p. 8). Period covered is Change on October 30, 2020 (FY2021). Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **E33.** GSA lists smaller PSC changes between the two big revisions. These include DLA product class updates and new medical service codes (Category Q) effective October 1, 2015, the end of D305 and new R616 and R617 in May 2019, and 11 new codes in March 2020. *Source PSC-Manual-April-2025, Revision Chart, V1.2 to V1.4, p. 2 (PDF p. 2). Period covered is FY2016, FY2019, FY2020. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **E34.** GSA made further PSC changes in April 2022, April 2024 and April 2025. The April 2024 version activated 6 service codes, end-dated 3, and added product codes 6506 and 6555. The April 2025 version activated product code 9105. *Source PSC-Manual-April-2025, Revision Chart, V1.9, p. 3 (PDF p. 3). Period covered is FY2022, FY2024, FY2025. Effect on the measure is small.*

Accuracy of codes. How often the codes match contract files, and what FPDS can and cannot fix.

- **D01.** GSA reported in its FY2022 and FY2023 data quality reports that FPDS limitations caused inaccurate values in two key fields, NAICS and Product or Service Code. FPDS does not let agencies change these fields to reflect the most current updates, and OMB had not responded as of December 2024. *Source GAO-25-107469, p. 25 with footnote 46 (PDF p. 30). Period covered is FY2022 to FY2023 (reported), unresolved as of December 2024. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **D02.** DoD's PSC rule is one code for the predominant amount of supplies or services on the award. CRS warns that a single PSC per contract hides other products or services on it. *Source R44010, p. 6 (PDF p. 10). Period covered is Current PGI. CRS 2018. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*

- **D03.** The FY2019 summary sampled about 20 FPDS elements against contract files. Product/Service Code matched 98.5% to 99.4% of the time, DUNS 98.6% to 99.8%, Action Obligation 97.5% to 99.7% and Description of Requirement 94.7% to 96.3%. Manual entry was the most common cause of errors. *Source FPDS-DQ-SUMMARY-FY2019, p. 1 (PDF p. 1), section E. Table values from Exhibit 1, p. 2 (PDF p. 2). Period covered is FY2014 to FY2019. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **D46.** DoD OIG found NAICS Code wrong in 138 sampled transactions. In 112 of them the contract documents did not show a code at all. *Source DODIG-2022-027, p. 14 (PDF p. 24). Period covered is FY2020 Q4. Effect on the measure is unknown.*

NAICS revisions. Industry codes change every five years at the start of a fiscal year.

- **E35.** SBA adopted each NAICS revision at the start of a fiscal year. NAICS 2007 took effect October 1, 2007, NAICS 2012 on October 1, 2012, NAICS 2017 on October 1, 2017 and NAICS 2022 on October 1, 2022. *Source FR-2022-20513, 87 FR 59240, Supplementary Information (PDF p. 1). Period covered is FY2008 to FY2025. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **E36.** The NAICS 2022 revision created 111 new industries by reclassifying, combining or splitting 156 NAICS 2017 industries. Retail trade had the most changes. *Source FR-2022-20513, 87 FR 59240, Summary (PDF p. 1). Period covered is FY2023 onward. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **E37.** SBA told buyers not to use NAICS 2022 codes before SBA updated its size standards, and said early use would cause data errors in SAM and FPDS-NG. SBA expected the update on October 1, 2022. *Source SBA-NAICS2022-guidance, Article paragraph 3 (Guidance on Using NAICS 2022 for Procurement). Period covered is FY2022 to FY2023. Effect on the measure is small.*

Topic 2. Vendor identity

Who answers for vendor and parent data, how often it is wrong, and which records name the wrong company. This topic holds 30 findings.

Who answers for parent data. Parent fields come from the recipient's registration, and agencies do not certify them.

- **D04.** The acquisition.gov clarification says agencies are not responsible for ultimate parent fields. Parent data come from SAM and Dun and Bradstreet, and errors in them are not the responsibility of procurement officials. *Source OMB-OFPP-clarifying-proc-data, p. 1 (PDF p. 1). Period covered is Undated (created 2021-01-04). Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **D05.** M-18-16 says the quality of SAM and subaward data is the legal duty of the award recipient, and agencies do not certify data reported by awardees. *Source M-18-16, p. 4, footnote 3 (PDF p. 4). Period covered is 2018-06-06 on. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **D13.** Vendor name and address in FPDS are fixed at the base award. Task and delivery orders carry the vendor data of the base IDV, and a SAM name change need not trigger a modification. *Source OMB-OFPP-clarifying-proc-data, p. 5 (PDF p. 5). Period covered is Undated (created 2021-01-04). Effect on the measure is bias risk.*

Parent ID and parent name errors. What inspectors general and GAO found when they tested parent fields.

- **D06.** DoD OIG found the Ultimate Parent Unique Identifier inaccurate or unsupported in all 57 sampled procurement transactions for FY2017 Q2. The report notes this is an FPDS-generated element. *Source DODIG-2018-020, p. 22 (PDF p. 32), Table 3. Period covered is FY2017 Q2. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **D07.** Inspectors general reviewing Q1 FY2019 data reported Ultimate Parent UEI and parent name errors. One OIG traced them to awardees not keeping their SAM data current. Five OIGs reported completeness error rates above 20% for Ultimate Parent Unique Identifier. *Source GAO-20-540, p. 17 (PDF p. 23), also p. 11 (PDF p. 17). Period covered is FY2019 Q1. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*

- **D08.** Inspectors general reviewing FY2020 to FY2021 data reported third-party errors in procurement records. Sixteen OIGs reported Ultimate Parent Unique Identifier errors and 22 reported Ultimate Parent Legal Entity Name errors that they attributed to systems such as SAM and FPDS. *Source GAO-22-105427, p. 20 (PDF p. 26), Table 4 on p. 21 (PDF p. 27). Period covered is One quarter per OIG among FY2020 Q3, FY2020 Q4, FY2021 Q1 and FY2021 Q2. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **D09.** In the 2021 cycle, 22 of 57 OIGs reported third-party errors in Ultimate Parent Legal Entity Name on procurement awards, second only to Legal Entity Congressional District. One OIG traced parent field errors to a third-party system that filled the agency file from the wrong field. *Source GAO-22-105427, p. 21 (PDF p. 27), Table 4. Period covered is Mostly FY2020 Q4 or FY2021 Q1. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **D10.** NASA OIG found 62 sampled transactions with wrong Ultimate Parent Legal Entity Name or Ultimate Parent Unique Identifier. Officials said parent changes made in SAM are not carried into FPDS-NG automatically. *Source IG-22-002, p. 16 (PDF p. 22). Period covered is FY2020 Q4. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **D11.** The DoD sample showed an 11.0 percent accuracy error rate for Ultimate Parent Legal Entity Name and a 1.3 percent rate for Ultimate Parent Unique Identifier. The parent name error rate rose from 0.5 percent in FY2019 Q1. *Source DODIG-2022-027, p. 41 (PDF p. 51), Table 5. Period covered is FY2020 Q4 (compared with FY2019 Q1). Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **D12.** One OIG found its agency had no clear procedure for recording FPDS-NG transactions after a vendor changed its business identification number. Another OIG traced parent and address errors to awardees not updating SAM. *Source GAO-20-540, p. 21 (PDF p. 27). Second sentence p. 17 (PDF p. 23). Period covered is FY2019 Q1. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **D35.** GAO found the parent DUNS number inconsistent with agency records for 26% to 35% of FY2012 awards. GAO said nearly all of these cases were assistance awards, because the field was not displayed for assistance awards. *Source GAO-14-476, p. 21 (PDF p. 25) and p. 22 (PDF p. 26). Period covered is FY2012. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **D53.** VA OIG rated VA's FY2020 Q4 submission moderate at 71.50 points. Only 5 of the 45 sampled records came from File D1, and one had a wrong Ultimate Parent Legal Entity Name caused by an entity other than VA. *Source 20-04237-09, p. 18 (PDF p. 23). Period covered is FY2020 Q4. Effect on the measure is unknown.*

Vendor ID changes. The move from DUNS to UEI in 2022 and related changes in how recipients are grouped.

- **E09.** The FPDS dictionary revision of 4/2/2022 removed element 9A Unique Entity ID (DUNS) and made 9M Unique Entity ID the primary entity key. GSA says all its systems stopped using DUNS on April 4, 2022. *Source FPDS-DD-V1.5, Revision History, version 3.26 (4/2/2022), p. 4 (PDF p. 6). Period covered is FY2022 Q3 onward. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **E10.** GSA says all registered entities had their new UEI from June 2021, and that SAM.gov and other GSA systems would no longer use the DUNS number from April 4, 2022. *Source GSA-NEWS-2022-03-16-UEI, GSA news release of March 16, 2022, paragraph 1. Period covered is June 2021 to April 2022. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **E11.** USAspending switched recipient grouping from DUNS to UEI in March 2022. It also fixed a bug that had kept recipients with null DUNS from flowing from the Broker. *Source USAS-RELEASE-NOTES-WIKI, Release notes, March 22nd, 2022, API and Technical Notes, "Unique Entity Identifier (UEI) updates". Period covered is March 2022 and September 2022 releases. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **E12.** USAspending warned in 2018 and 2019 that a parent recipient can change over time and that a child recipient name could replace the ultimate parent name. *Source USAS-RELEASE-NOTES-WIKI, Release notes, October 31, 2018, Website Updates, "Updated the Recipient Profile". Period covered is October 2018 and February 2019 releases. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*

- **E38.** An October 2021 revision, made ahead of the switch, made UEI (SAM) optional or system-generated from UEI (DUNS). *Source FPDS-DD-V1.5, Revision History, version 3.22 (10/30/2021), p. 4 (PDF p. 6). Period covered is October 2021 to April 2022. Effect on the measure is already handled.*
- **G28.** GAO matched FY2023 to FY2024 USAspending.gov awards to SAM by UEI. Of 20.3 million contract and assistance awards, 12.8 million had a valid UEI, 7.4 million had none (mostly aggregate assistance awards) and 2,969 had a UEI that did not match SAM. *Source GAO-26-107466, p. 44 (PDF p. 50). Period covered is FY2023 to FY2024. Effect on the measure is small.*

Consortium managers and other middlemen. Records that name a pass-through manager instead of the firms doing the work.

- **D18.** HHS ASPR reported its COVID-19 OTAs in the FPDS-NG procurement contract module instead of the OTA module. GAO said this overstated ASPR's COVID-19 procurement contracts by $1.55 billion as of March 14, 2021. *Source GAO-21-501, p. 17 (PDF p. 22). Period covered is March 2020 to March 14, 2021 (FY2020 to FY2021). Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **D19.** FPDS-NG showed one consortium management firm receiving $7.2 billion in COVID-19 OTAs. GAO found the firm passed nearly all of it to five pharmaceutical companies, each receiving $450 million to $2 billion. *Source GAO-21-501, Highlights (PDF p. 2) and p. 30 (PDF p. 35). Period covered is March 2020 to March 2021. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **D20.** Three of the top five prototype OT recipients in FPDS-NG were consortium management firms. FPDS-NG did not show which consortium members carried out the projects. *Source GAO-20-84, p. 13 (PDF p. 17), Table 1 and notes. Period covered is FY2016 to FY2018. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **D21.** In the FPDS OTA recipient field, DoD staff typically enter the consortium management organization. FPDS had no field naming the consortium, and before June 2022 no field for the consortium members doing the work. *Source GAO-22-105357, p. 20 (PDF p. 25). Period covered is FY2019 to FY2021, with an FPDS change in June 2022. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **D22.** FPDS added consortium fields in 2022. GAO then checked FY2023 and FY2024 OTA records tied to known consortium managers. DoD filled them correctly for 2,036 of 2,431 records (84 percent). The other 395 records still named the consortium manager as the vendor performing the work. *Source GAO-25-107546, p. 14 (PDF p. 19). Period covered is FY2023 to FY2024. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **F34.** In June 2022 the agencies updated FPDS to record whether an OTA is consortium-based and which members perform the work. GAO notes that FPDS updates are resource constrained and need a majority vote of 24 agencies to be funded. *Source GAO-22-105357, p. 19 (PDF p. 24) and p. 20 (PDF p. 25). Period covered is 2022. Effect on the measure is unknown.*

Generic IDs and consolidated reports. Placeholder vendor IDs and single rows that stand for many actions.

- **A29.** DoD adds its own exclusions. Ordering officers do not report orders under USTRANSCOM transportation vehicles or DLA Energy vehicles because those commands report them in consolidated form. *Source PGI-204.6, PGI 204.606(2)(i)(A). Period covered is Current PGI. Effect on the measure is counts only.*
- **D14.** The FAC 2005-62 preamble says a generic DUNS such as Miscellaneous Foreign Vendor masks the contractor's identity beyond the local contracting office. The rule set limits on generic identifiers from 2012-12-20. *Source FAC-2005-62, FAC 2005-62, Item I, preamble section I. Period covered is 2012-12-20 on. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **D15.** DoD lists the generic UEIs it allows, including Miscellaneous Foreign Awardees, used for vendors outside the United States with no UEI. *Source PGI-204.6, PGI 204.606(6)(ii)(B). Period covered is Current PGI. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*

- **D16.** DoD purchase card orders under contracts may be filed as consolidated express reports under the generic UEI for GPC Consolidated Reporting, and such reports must use Other than Small Business. *Source PGI-204.6, PGI 204.606(5)(ii)(C). Period covered is Current PGI. Same rule with DUNS 136721250 since 2011-09-20. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **D17.** An express report sums many actions into one record. The Number of Actions field holds the count, and the obligation fields hold the summed dollars. *Source PGI-204.6, PGI 204.606(1)(iii)(C). Period covered is Current PGI. Same rule since at least the 2011-09-20 revision. Effect on the measure is counts only.*
- **F30.** The acquisition.gov clarification says express reporting gives one FPDS record but many financial obligations, and that financial adjustments such as discounts, penalties and interest are not reported in FPDS. *Source OMB-OFPP-clarifying-proc-data, p. 4 (PDF p. 4). Period covered is Undated (created 2021-01-04). Effect on the measure is counts only.*

Topic 3. Spending outside the data

Spending that never enters FPDS by rule, and buyers that do not report to it. This topic holds 55 findings.

Other transaction agreements. OTAs sit outside FAR contract data, and their own reporting is incomplete.

- **A01.** GAO's contracting snapshots state that other transaction agreement data are not included in federal contract obligations. They report OTA spending separately, at $16.5 billion in FY2020, nearly $16 billion in FY2023, $18.4 billion in FY2024 and $18.2 billion in FY2025. *Source GAO-DASHBOARD-FY2025-DATA, textData.ota2. Period covered is FY2016 to FY2025. Effect on the measure is scope.*
- **A02.** DoD obligations through prototype and production OTAs grew from $1.8 billion in FY2016 to over $18 billion in FY2024. From FY2021 to FY2024 DoD obligated $62.9 billion on OTAs, and 10 vendors received about 57 percent of it. *Source GAO-25-107546, Highlights (PDF p. 2) and p. 9 (PDF p. 14). Period covered is FY2016 to FY2024. Effect on the measure is scope.*
- **A03.** GAO found that over $40 billion in other transaction agreements (OTAs) appeared on an agency website or in the FPDS OTA Module but were not reported to USAspending.gov. More than $10 billion appeared COVID-19 related. The data covered FY2020 to FY2022. *Source GAO-24-106214, p. 6 (PDF p. 6). Period covered is FY2020 to FY2022, data obtained December 2022 to June 2023. Effect on the measure is scope.*
- **A04.** FPDS holds DoD prototype and production OTAs in a separate OTA module. DoD does not report research OTAs to FPDS at all because they count as assistance instruments. *Source GAO-22-105357, p. 3 (PDF p. 8), footnote 6. Period covered is FY2019 to FY2021. Effect on the measure is scope.*
- **A05.** GAO reported that USAspending.gov has no identifier for OTAs. OMB told agencies to report OTAs by the funding type they resemble, while Treasury said OTAs are not federal awards under FFATA and should not be reported. *Source GAO-24-106214, p. 6 to 7 (PDF p. 6 to 7). Period covered is FY2020 to FY2022. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **A31.** GAO counted OTA use for FY2010 to FY2014 from each agency's own systems and documents. It noted that agencies use various data systems to track OTAs. Eleven federal agencies hold OTA authority. *Source GAO-16-209, p. 2 (PDF p. 6), footnote 3. Period covered is FY2010 to FY2014. Effect on the measure is scope.*
- **B06.** DoD, HHS and DHS reported $10.9 billion of COVID-19 OTAs in FPDS-NG, but GAO found at least $12.5 billion, a $1.6 billion gap. NIH also obligated about $520 million on COVID-19 OTAs that were not reported in FPDS-NG at all. *Source GAO-21-501, p. 16 (PDF p. 21). Period covered is March 2020 to March 2021. Effect on the measure is scope.*
- **D68.** GAO found 8 of 244 other transactions wrongly coded as prototype OTs in FPDS-NG. Until June 2019 FPDS-NG could not tell prototype from production OTs, so DoD reported both as prototype. *Source GAO-20-84, p. 3 (PDF p. 7) and p. 15 (PDF p. 19). Period covered is FY2016 to FY2018. Effect on the measure is scope.*

- **D69.** Comparing FPDS with DoD and consortium manager data, GAO found OTA obligations both underreported and overreported in FPDS. Some consortia-based OTAs were not in FPDS at all. *Source GAO-22-105357, p. 48 (PDF p. 53). Period covered is Prototype OTAs FY2019 to FY2021. Production OTAs June 29, 2019, to September 30, 2021. Effect on the measure is scope.*
- **D70.** The FPDS-NG OTA module had no National Interest Action field, so agencies had no systematic way to flag an OTA as COVID-19 related. The procurement module does have that field. DoD did not flag $52.5 million on the Pfizer OTA and DHS did not flag $25.5 million on two OTAs as COVID-19 related. *Source GAO-21-501, p. 19 (PDF p. 24) and p. 17 (PDF p. 22). Period covered is February 2020 to March 2021. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **D79.** GAO found DoD's FY2023 report to Congress on FAR production contracts that followed prototype OTAs was unreliable. Only 7 of 48 contracts DoD listed were actual follow-on production contracts. *Source GAO-25-107546, p. 13 (PDF p. 18). Period covered is FY2023. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **D89.** CRS found two fiscal year fields on DoD prototype OT records that users fill in different ways. One record shows $115 million obligated in FY2020 for an agreement signed in February 2016. *Source R45521, p. 37 (PDF p. 41). Period covered is FY2013 to FY2017. Effect on the measure is timing.*
- **E17.** DoD began reporting production OTAs in FPDS only on June 29, 2019. GAO could not measure production OTA obligations from October 1, 2018, through June 28, 2019. *Source GAO-22-105357, p. 3 (PDF p. 8). Period covered is FY2019. Effect on the measure is scope.*
- **E18.** CRS says DoD planned to report all OT data through FPDS-NG starting in late 2019. Research OTs were tracked earlier in the Defense Assistance Awards Data System with grants. *Source R45521, p. 11 (PDF p. 15). Period covered is FY2015 to FY2025, with a break in late 2019. Effect on the measure is scope.*
- **E32.** FPDS Version 1.4 (October 2009) added Treasury Account information and new services for Other Transaction awards and IDVs. *Source FPDS-SPEC-V1.4-CHANGES, Section 3 Executive Summary, p. 1 (PDF p. 5). Period covered is FY2010 onward. Effect on the measure is unknown.*

Classified and national security actions. Actions kept out of FPDS to protect classified information.

- **A06.** FAR 4.606(c)(6) bars reporting of contract actions whose required data would be classified. The 2011 proposed rule said FPDS is not approved to hold classified data and the FAR had not said so expressly. *Source FR-2011-30622, 76 FR 73564, preamble, discussion of FAR 4.606. Period covered is Explicit in the FAR from 2012-12-20 (FAC 2005-62). Practice predates it per the 2011 preamble. Effect on the measure is scope.*
- **A07.** FAR 4.606(c)(5) bars reporting of actions that other authority keeps out of FPDS, with national security as the example. *Source FAR-4.6, FAR 4.606(c)(5). Period covered is Current FAR. Present before the December 2012 rule, which added (c)(6) to (c)(11). Effect on the measure is scope.*
- **A08.** DoD also bars reporting of contracts, agreements or orders that are themselves classified. *Source PGI-204.6, PGI 204.606(2)(ii). Period covered is Current PGI. Effect on the measure is scope.*
- **F13.** M-17-04 tells agencies not to disclose classified activities in DATA Act submissions, including unclassified data that become classified when aggregated. *Source M-17-04, p. 1 (PDF p. 1). Period covered is May 2017 on. Effect on the measure is scope.*

Small purchases and purchase cards. What must be reported above the micro-purchase threshold, and what may be left out below it.

- **A09.** FAR 4.603(b) and 4.606(a)(1) set the floor for FPDS reporting. Agencies must report unclassified contract actions above the micro-purchase threshold, plus any modification that changes reported data at any dollar value. *Source FAR-4.6, FAR 4.603(b). Period covered is Current FAR (FAC 2026-01). Same structure since FAC 2005-25 (2008-04-22). Effect on the measure is scope.*

- **A11.** FAR 4.606(c)(1) bars reporting of imprest fund transactions below the micro-purchase threshold, including purchase card buys, unless an agency's own procedures call for reporting them. *Source FAR-4.6, FAR 4.606(c)(1). Period covered is Current FAR. Same wording in the 2008 interim rule. Effect on the measure is scope.*
- **A12.** DoD tells offices not to report open-market purchase card buys below the micro-purchase threshold. *Source PGI-204.6, PGI 204.606(5)(i). Period covered is Current PGI. Same rule since the 2011-09-20 revision. Effect on the measure is scope.*
- **A23.** USAspending says agencies must report contract awards above the micro-purchase threshold to FPDS under FAR 4.606. It gives the threshold as $10,000 as of 2022, with a few exceptions. *Source USAS-ATD-reporting-threshold-for-prime-awards, About the Data, "Reporting Threshold for Prime Awards", paragraph 2. Period covered is ongoing. Effect on the measure is scope.*
- **A24.** USAspending lists sub-threshold awards as one cause of unlinked awards. An agency may report a micro-purchase in File C but not in File D1, or the reverse. *Source USAS-ATD-limited-data-for-unlinked-prime-awards, About the Data, "Limited Data for Unlinked Prime Awards", list of other causes, item 3. Period covered is FY2017 Q2 onward. Effect on the measure is scope.*
- **A25.** GSA describes the contract award data now searched in SAM.gov as all unclassified contract actions above the micro-purchase threshold, plus modifications that change reported data at any dollar value. *Source SAM-FPDS, sam.gov/fpds, section "ezSearch", paragraph 3. Period covered is 2026. Effect on the measure is scope.*
- **A26.** FFATA required contracts above $25,000 on USASpending.gov, while FPDS-NG held contracts above the micro-purchase threshold, then $3,000. GAO also said no authoritative source lists all contracts each agency issues. *Source GAO-14-476, p. 4, footnote 5 (PDF p. 8), and p. 11, footnote 26 (PDF p. 15). Period covered is FY2012 (rule in force at the time). Effect on the measure is counts only.*
- **A27.** Actions at or below the micro-purchase threshold are optional. FAR 4.606(b)(1) lets an agency report them only if they can be kept apart from FAR-based actions and the FPDS Program Office approves in writing. *Source FAR-4.6, FAR 4.606(b) introductory text and (b)(1). Period covered is Current FAR. Written approval and segregation wording dates from FAC 2005-62 (effective 2012-12-20). Effect on the measure is counts only.*
- **A28.** DoD encourages, but does not require, reports for purchase orders under micro-purchase procedures below the threshold that were not paid by purchase card or Standard Form 44. *Source PGI-204.6, PGI 204.606(1)(i)(B)(2). Period covered is Current PGI. Same text in the 2014 revision. Effect on the measure is counts only.*
- **A30.** FAR 4.606(a)(2) says GSA's charge card office will give purchase card data to FPDS at least yearly for reports. The text does not say these data become contract action rows. *Source FAR-4.6, FAR 4.606(a)(2). Period covered is Current FAR. Paragraph (a)(3) in the 2008 interim rule. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **F16.** CRS says purchase card spending rose from $527.0 million in FY1993 to $19.5 billion in FY2011, with almost 22.8 million transactions in FY2011. *Source R46106, p. 2 (PDF p. 5). Period covered is FY1993 to FY2011. Effect on the measure is scope.*

Other channels excluded by rule. Stock, store, resale, interagency and non-appropriated fund purchases, and other exclusions.

- **A10.** The FPDS welcome text lists what FPDS does not hold. The list includes purchase card data, data from agencies not subject to FAR reporting rules, interagency agreements, imprest fund transactions and actions paid only with non-appropriated funds. *Source FPDS-WELCOME, FPDS welcome text, section "What's not in FPDS-NG?". Period covered is page dated 2011, still served 2026. Effect on the measure is scope.*
- **A13.** FPDS covers appropriated funds only. FAR 4.603(d) says mixed-funded actions report only the appropriated part, and 4.606(b)(2) makes non-appropriated fund actions optional with approval. *Source FAR-4.6, FAR 4.603(d). Period covered is Current FAR. Mixed funding rule since FAC 2005-25 (2008). Approval*

wording since 2012-12-20. Effect on the measure is scope.

- **A14.** The FAR definition of a contract action excludes grants, cooperative agreements, other transactions, real property leases, requisitions from Federal stock, training authorizations and other non-FAR transactions. *Source FAR-4.6, FAR 4.601, definition of contract action. Period covered is Current FAR. Same definition in the 2008 interim rule. Effect on the measure is scope.*
- **A15.** GAO defined contract obligations in FPDS-NG as obligations on FAR-based contracts. They exclude grants, cooperative agreements, loans, other transactions for research, real property leases and requisitions from federal stock. *Source GAO-20-632, p. 2 (PDF p. 6), footnote 4. Period covered is FY2020 (data as of June 11, 2020). Effect on the measure is scope.*
- **A18.** FAR 4.606(c)(2) bars reporting of orders from GSA stock and the GSA Global Supply Program. *Source FAR-4.6, FAR 4.606(c)(2). Period covered is Current FAR. Same wording in the 2008 interim rule. Effect on the measure is scope.*
- **A19.** FAR 4.606(c)(3) bars reporting of purchases at GSA or AbilityOne service stores, because GSA already reported the stocked items. *Source FAR-4.6, FAR 4.606(c)(3). Period covered is Current FAR. The 2008 interim rule used the older JWOD name. Effect on the measure is scope.*
- **A20.** FAR 4.606(c)(7) to (c)(9) bar reporting of resale (commissary or exchange), revenue generating concessions, and training expenditures not issued as orders or contracts. *Source FAR-4.6, FAR 4.606(c)(7). Period covered is Current FAR. These were optional with notice to the FPDS Program Office from 2008-04-22 to 2012-12-19. Effect on the measure is scope.*
- **A21.** FAR 4.606(c)(10) bars reporting of interagency agreements other than the interagency acquisitions that 4.606(a)(1) requires. *Source FAR-4.6, FAR 4.606(c)(10). Period covered is Current FAR. Optional with notice before 2012-12-20. Effect on the measure is scope.*
- **A22.** FAR 4.606(c)(4) bars reporting of purchases with non-appropriated fund activity cards, chaplain fund cards, individual training orders and Defense Printing orders. *Source FAR-4.6, FAR 4.606(c)(4). Period covered is Current FAR. Same list in the 2008 interim rule. Effect on the measure is scope.*
- **A32.** SBA's small business goaling report leaves out certain contract dollars when computing small business shares, mainly contracts not subject to the FAR. SBA put the FY2011 base after these exclusions at $423 billion. *Source GAO-12-873, p. 2 (PDF p. 7), footnote 4. Period covered is FY2011. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **A33.** FAR 4.606(c)(11) bars reporting of letters of obligation used in the A-76 process. *Source FAR-4.6, FAR 4.606(c)(11). Period covered is Current FAR. Optional with notice before 2012-12-20. Effect on the measure is small.*

Buyers outside the FAR or FPDS, and agencies that do not report. Agencies and branches absent from FPDS, and agencies that submit empty or no files.

- **A16.** DOE may count small business subcontracts toward its small business prime contracting goal, starting in 2014. NNSA prime contracts reach FPDS through DOE's procurement system, while M&O subcontracts are reported in MOSRC and eSRS instead. *Source GAO-25-106820, p. 1 (PDF p. 5) and p. 9 (PDF p. 13). Period covered is FY2014 onward. Effect on the measure is scope.*
- **A17.** GAO noted that the FAR does not apply to all executive branch agencies. It generally does not cover acquisitions funded with nonappropriated funds, and some agencies, such as the FAA, have authority to use other acquisition systems. *Source GAO-25-107469, p. 13 (PDF p. 18). Period covered is Current rule (2025). Effect on the measure is scope.*
- **B03.** In FY2012, 33 of 37 agencies with budget authority of at least $400 million showed at least one contract on USASpending.gov. FDIC, NCUA and TVA said their contracts use non-appropriated funds and are exempt. The CIA did not report contracts at all. *Source GAO-14-476, p. 12 (PDF p. 16), with footnote 27 on p. 11 (PDF*

p. 15). Period covered is FY2012. Effect on the measure is scope.

- **B04.** CRS says FPDS has no data from judicial branch agencies, the legislative branch, certain DoD components, or some executive agencies such as CIA and NSA. *Source R44010, p. 2 (PDF p. 6). Period covered is Stated in 2018. Applies to all years. Effect on the measure is scope.*
- **B05.** GAO found that 49 of 152 agencies in the FY2022 consolidated financial statements did not report to USAspending.gov. Twenty-five of them were executive branch agencies with more than $5 billion in FY2022 net outlays. GAO did not check which of them were required to report. *Source GAO-24-106214, p. 1 (PDF p. 1), p. 4 (PDF p. 4). Period covered is FY2022. Effect on the measure is scope.*
- **B07.** GAO said in 2009 that it could not rely only on FPDS-NG for contracting in Iraq and Afghanistan because not all contract actions were entered. The underlying review was GAO-09-19 from October 2008. *Source GAO-09-1032T, p. 5 (PDF p. 7). Period covered is Review published October 2008 (GAO-09-19). Effect on the measure is scope.*
- **B08.** VA OIG warned that VA's File D1 may be incomplete. VA records some contract actions on Form 1358 miscellaneous obligations outside its contract system, and these do not flow to FPDS-NG unless staff import them by hand. *Source 20-04237-09, p. 9 (PDF p. 14). Period covered is FY2020 Q4. Effect on the measure is scope.*
- **B09.** One OIG recommended its agency limit an accounting system option that skips the automatic creation of an FPDS-NG entry for contract actions. *Source GAO-20-540, p. 26 (PDF p. 32). Period covered is FY2019 Q1. Effect on the measure is scope.*
- **B10.** FAR 4.606(d) says agencies not subject to the FAR may be required by other authority to report to FPDS, and must first get FPDS Program Office approval. *Source FAR-4.6, FAR 4.606(d). Period covered is Current FAR. Approval clause added 2012-12-20. Effect on the measure is scope.*
- **B11.** USAspending lists entities that do not report spending data under the DATA Act. The list includes the legislative branch, the judicial branch (other than the Court of Appeals for Veterans Claims), USPS, TVA, the Smithsonian, the Federal Reserve, Amtrak, FHFA and the Intelligence Community Management Account. *Source USAS-ATD-reporting-requirement-for-federal-agencies, About the Data, "Reporting Requirement for Federal Agencies", list "Examples of non-reporting entities include". Period covered is ongoing. Effect on the measure is scope.*
- **B12.** For Q2 FY2017, GAO found 28 agencies that should have reported DATA Act data but submitted nothing. Seventeen of them showed almost $2 billion in obligations on their SF 133 reports. Thirteen agencies, including DoD and USDA, submitted a File C with no data. *Source GAO-18-138, p. 17 (PDF p. 22). Period covered is FY2017 Q2. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **B13.** One OIG reported that its agency's Q1 FY2019 submission left out almost $10 billion in award-level data for two components. Fourteen of 51 OIGs said their agency's submission was missing data. *Source GAO-20-540, p. 11 (PDF p. 17). Period covered is FY2019 Q1. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **B14.** For the period ending March 31, 2021, 30 agencies submitted a File D1 with no procurement data and 19 of 101 agencies submitted an empty File C. In November 2019 GAO had counted 34 blank File D1 submissions. *Source GAO-22-104702, p. 11 (PDF p. 17). Period covered is FY2021 Q2 (period ending March 31, 2021). Effect on the measure is small.*
- **B15.** Eight agencies in the FY2025 period 12 submission statistics show no publication date, so they filed no DATA Act financial submission for that period. They are VEF, NCD, USICH, FFIEC, the Kennedy Center, ARC, AAHC and OPIC. *Source USAS-REPORTING-OVERVIEW-FY2025-P12-p2, results[].recent_publication_date for these 8 agencies (pages 1 and 2). Quote shows the VEF record on page 2. Period covered is FY2025 P12. Effect on the measure is small.*

Topic 4. Which agency gets the dollars

How buying for other agencies and reorganizations move dollars between agency cells. This topic holds 14 findings.

Buying for other agencies. Assisted acquisitions, shared service providers and the 2025 shift to GSA.

- **B01.** GAO reported that the Treasury broker pulled FPDS-NG data by awarding agency rather than funding agency, so some agencies' procurement data appeared in their shared service provider's File D1. Agencies said Treasury fixed this starting Q1 FY2019. *Source GAO-20-75, p. 10, footnote 26 (PDF p. 16). Period covered is FY2018 Q4. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **B02.** For Q4 FY2018, 34 non-CFO Act agencies submitted an empty File D1. Agencies said their procurement went into a shared service provider's file, their awards were below the micro-purchase threshold, or they did not use FPDS-NG. *Source GAO-20-75, p. 10 (PDF p. 16). Period covered is FY2018 Q4. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **D23.** GAO said in 2009 that interagency contracts could not always be identified in FPDS-NG because of how they were coded. It also found the major program field at DHS was typically blank and some contracts were wrongly coded as time-and-materials or as commercial services. *Source GAO-09-1032T, p. 4 (PDF p. 6). Period covered is Reviews published April 2008 to June 2009. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **D86.** The USAspending Data Dictionary says the FPDS agencyID inside the contract transaction key is the agency that submitted the record, which often differs from the awarding agency. *Source USAS-DATA-DICTIONARY, document.rows, element ContractTransactionUniqueKey, definition. Period covered is all years. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **E16.** GAO said in 2005 that no system tracked total spending through other agencies' contract vehicles and services. GSA said FPDS-NG was not meant to collect data on financial transactions between agencies. *Source GAO-05-960R, p. 4 (PDF p. 4). Period covered is 2005 (pre-FY2008). Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **G01.** Executive Order 14240 of March 20, 2025 directs agencies to have GSA buy common goods and services. It also makes the GSA Administrator executive agent for all government-wide IT acquisition contracts. *Source EO-14240, 90 FR 13671, Sec. 1 (PDF p. 1). Period covered is FY2025 onward. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **G02.** OMB reports that in FY2024 $78.2 billion went through GSA vehicles and $16.3 billion was awarded by GSA on behalf of funding agencies as assisted acquisitions. OMB M-25-31 tells agencies to centralize more buying in GSA. *Source M-25-31, Appendix, footnote 4, p. 1 (PDF p. 2). Period covered is FY2024 to FY2025. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **G03.** GSA created an Office of Centralized Acquisition Services to take over procurement authority for designated contracts from other agencies. *Source GSA-procurement-consolidation, Page body, paragraph 2. Period covered is 2025 to 2026. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **G15.** DHS met the needs of 30 terminated IT IDIQ contracts through existing government-wide contracts. It obligated over $1.7 billion that way in FY2025. *Source GAO-26-109096, p. 10 (PDF p. 10). Period covered is FY2025. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*

Reorganizations and agency code changes. Moves of work between agencies and changes in how agency codes are used.

- **E13.** On October 21, 2019 USAspending stopped grouping USACE Civil Works under DoD. Archive downloads filtered on DoD stopped including USACE. *Source USAS-RELEASE-NOTES-WIKI, Release notes, October 21, 2019, Website Updates and Fixes. Period covered is October 2019 onward. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*

- **E14.** USAID and State told Congress in March 2025 that they would reorganize foreign assistance programming. State officials told GAO that State has no access to information on terminated contracts held in USAID legacy systems. *Source GAO-26-108615, Footnote 10, p. 4 (PDF p. 8), repeated in Appendix I footnote 3, p. 35 (PDF p. 39). Period covered is FY2025. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **E15.** Executive Order 13869 moved the primary responsibility for government-wide background investigations from OPM to the Department of Defense. The NBIB transition period ended on or before September 30, 2019. *Source EO-13869, 84 FR 18125, Sec. 1 (PDF p. 1). Period covered is FY2019 to FY2020. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **E42.** Four DoD agency codes (97AB, 97CG, 97CR, 97DL) may not be used as the Funding Agency Code on or after 4/27/2024, to reduce operational security risk. *Source FPDS-DD-V1.5, Element 4C Program/Funding Agency Code, Notes, p. 46 (PDF p. 48). Period covered is FY2024 Q3 onward. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **F37.** DHS contracting staff picked wrong funding office codes in FPDS-NG. DHS said GSA, which runs the Federal Hierarchy feeding FPDS-NG, wrongly added hundreds of offices to the DHS hierarchy. *Source OIG-22-04, p. 21 (PDF p. 24). Period covered is FY2020 Q4. Effect on the measure is small.*

Topic 5. Data quality over time and who checks it

How quality was tested, what the tests found, and how oversight changed. This topic holds 57 findings.

GAO tests of whole records. GAO's samples that trace award records back to agency records.

- **D25.** GAO traced a random sample of 385 FY2012 awards on USASpending.gov back to agency records. Only 2% to 7% of awards matched agency records on all 21 data elements GAO tested. *Source GAO-14-476, Highlights (PDF p. 2), also p. 19 (PDF p. 23). Period covered is FY2012. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **D26.** For Q2 FY2017, GAO estimated that only 0% to 1% of award records were fully consistent with agency sources, down from 2% to 7% in its 2014 review. Budgetary records did much better at 56% to 75%. *Source GAO-18-138, p. 20 (PDF p. 25). Period covered is FY2017 Q2 (January to March 2017). Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **D27.** For Q4 FY2018, GAO estimated that 24% to 34% of award transactions were fully consistent with agency sources, up from 0% to 1% in Q2 FY2017. GAO saw the gain despite a stricter definition and more fields tested. *Source GAO-20-75, p. 15 (PDF p. 21). Period covered is FY2018 Q4 (July to September 2018). Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **D28.** At the element level for Q4 FY2018, Federal Action Obligation was 91% to 97% consistent and Awarding Agency Name 98% to 100%. NAICS got worse than in Q2 FY2017, with 23% to 38% of procurement records inconsistent. PSC and parent UEI were not tested. *Source GAO-20-75, p. 17 (PDF p. 23), Table 4 on p. 52 (PDF p. 58). Period covered is FY2018 Q4. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **D29.** At the data element level in Q2 FY2017, only Awarding Agency Name was significantly consistent among 26 award elements. Federal Action Obligation was 84% to 92% consistent. NAICS was 68% to 85% consistent and Current Total Value of Award only 33% to 52% for procurement awards. PSC was not tested. *Source GAO-18-138, p. 21 (PDF p. 26), Table 4 on p. 61 (PDF p. 66). Period covered is FY2017 Q2. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **D34.** GAO reported that its 2010 review found every one of 100 sampled awards on USASpending.gov had at least one data error, and grants from programs at nine agencies were missing for FY2008. *Source GAO-14-476, p. 9 (PDF p. 13), citing GAO-10-365. Period covered is FY2008. Effect on the measure is unknown.*

Inspector general audits. The DATA Act audits of FY2017 to FY2021 and GAO's summaries of them.

- **D36.** GAO summarized 53 inspector general reports on Q2 FY2017 data. Only 15 OIGs found their agency data generally complete, timely, accurate, or of quality. GAO said the OIG error rates are not comparable and no government-wide rate can be projected. *Source GAO-18-546, p. 16 (PDF p. 21). Period covered is FY2017 Q2. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **D37.** For FY2017 Q2, 15 of 53 OIGs found their agency's data generally complete, timely, accurate or of quality. The other 38 did not. *Source GAO-18-546, p. 16 (PDF p. 21). Period covered is FY2017 Q2. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **D38.** GAO said the FY2017 Q2 OIG error rates are not comparable across agencies and cannot be projected to a government-wide rate. *Source GAO-18-546, p. 19 (PDF p. 24). Period covered is FY2017 Q2. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **D39.** For FY2019 Q1, 37 of 51 OIGs reported higher quality data under a 20 percent error benchmark, and 11 reported moderate or lower quality. Fourteen OIGs said some components' or systems' data were missing. *Source GAO-20-540, Highlights (PDF p. 2). Period covered is FY2019 Q1. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **D40.** In the 2021 cycle, 45 of 57 OIGs rated their agency's DATA Act data excellent or higher. Eight rated it moderate and four rated it lower. *Source GAO-22-105427, Highlights (PDF p. 2). Period covered is Mostly FY2020 Q4 or FY2021 Q1 (agency choice). Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **D41.** DoD OIG projected error rates of 6.5 percent for accuracy, 0.7 percent for completeness and 13.6 percent for timeliness for DoD's FY2020 Q4 award data. These rates pool File C (financial) with Files D1 and D2 (award) data elements. *Source DODIG-2022-027, p. ii (PDF p. 4). Period covered is FY2020 Q4. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **D42.** Most DoD errors sat in File D1 and came from how data was entered into FPDS-NG. Of 3,429 errors found in Files C, D1 and D2, 3,179 were in File D1. *Source DODIG-2022-027, p. 15 (PDF p. 25). Period covered is FY2020 Q4. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **D43.** DoD OIG rated the DoD FY2020 Q4 DATA Act submission as moderate quality. It scored 80 of 100 points on the CIGIE scorecard. *Source DODIG-2022-027, p. 17 (PDF p. 27). Period covered is FY2020 Q4. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **D44.** For DoD's FY2019 Q1 submission, File D1 had projected error rates of 0.5 percent for completeness, 13.4 percent for accuracy and 21.0 percent for timeliness. DoD OIG rated DoD procurement data as moderate quality. *Source DODIG-2020-010, p. ii (PDF p. 4). Period covered is FY2019 Q1. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **D47.** DoD management objected that the FY2019 Q1 statistical sample was mostly Defense Logistics Agency procurement data and did not reflect all of DoD. *Source DODIG-2020-010, p. iii (PDF p. 5). Period covered is FY2019 Q1. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **D48.** DHS OIG found DHS procurement data elements of high quality for FY2020 Q4. Procurement correctness rates were 99.4 percent for completeness, 89.3 percent for accuracy and 99.4 percent for timeliness. *Source OIG-22-04, p. 17 (PDF p. 20), Table 6. Period covered is FY2020 Q4. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **D49.** DHS OIG found 14 procurement data elements with inaccurate data at least 10 percent of the time because of weak DHS controls. *Source OIG-22-04, p. 20 (PDF p. 23), footnote 36. Period covered is FY2020 Q4. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **D50.** DOE OIG rated DOE's FY2021 Q1 data excellent at 98.9 points. The sample error rates were 1.53 percent for completeness, 2.70 percent for accuracy and 0.01 percent for timeliness. *Source DOE-OIG-22-03, Highlights, memo p. 2 (PDF p. 3). Period covered is FY2021 Q1. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **D51.** HHS OIG rated HHS's FY2021 Q1 data excellent at 99 points. The projected accuracy error rate was 1.45 percent, and 36 period of performance dates in Files D1 and D2 did not match the documents. *Source A-17-21-54000, p. 12 (PDF p. 14). Period covered is FY2021 Q1. Effect on the measure is small.*

- **D52.** GSA OIG projected a 4.76 percent accuracy error rate for GSA's FY2021 Q1 data elements. The most common error, Legal Entity Congressional District, came from a flaw in how File D is derived from FPDS-NG. *Source A210023/B/R/F22001, p. 7 (PDF p. 11). Period covered is FY2021 Q1. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **F09.** GAO noted that the DATA Act requirement for inspectors general to review agency data submissions expired in 2021. GAO asked Congress in March 2022 to consider extending it. *Source GAO-24-106214, p. 7 (PDF p. 7). Period covered is 2022 and later. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **F10.** The DATA Act required OIGs to publish their third and final reports in November 2021. *Source GAO-22-105427, p. 2 (PDF p. 8). Period covered is FY2017 Q2 to FY2021 Q1. Effect on the measure is unknown.*

Agencies' own checks and certification. The annual verification and certification of FPDS data, and how well agencies follow it.

- **D30.** OMB said the 24 CFO Act agencies self-certified FPDS data as 97.68% accurate and 99.14% complete and timely on average for FY2017 to FY2022. GAO separately found DOE's sampling not statistically valid and GSA's sampling procedures not documented in enough detail. *Source GAO-25-107469, p. 2 (PDF p. 7), p. 18 to 19 (PDF p. 23 to 24). Period covered is FY2017 to FY2022 (self-certified), FY2023 (GAO review of procedures). Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **D31.** HHS and VA reported FPDS accuracy below their own 95% target for several key fields in FY2021 to FY2023 and documented no corrective action plans. HHS dollar value fields were near 80% accurate. *Source GAO-25-107469, p. 22 (PDF p. 27). Period covered is FY2021 to FY2023. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **D32.** OFPP in 2009 found the FY2008 sampling guidance too weak to measure the accuracy of specific data elements by agency, and agencies sampled in inconsistent ways. *Source OFPP-2009-10-07, p. 1 (PDF p. 1). Period covered is FY2008 data. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **D33.** OFPP's required accuracy test is agency-wide. The sample must give 95% confidence with no more than 5 points of error for the whole agency, with element rates for fields such as Action Obligation, Funding Agency ID, PSC and DUNS. *Source OFPP-2011-05-31, Exhibit 3, item 1 (PDF p. 8). Period covered is FY2009 data on (2009 memo), repeated in 2011. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **F05.** None of the 24 CFO Act agencies' FY2023 procurement data quality reports met all relevant OMB requirements. Nineteen of 24 missed the deadline, three by more than 180 days. OMB tracks reports only for CFO Act agencies and has no monitoring procedures. *Source GAO-25-107469, p. 14 (PDF p. 19), p. 16 (PDF p. 21). Period covered is FY2023. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **F06.** Of 70 agencies that reported FY2023 data to FPDS, only 36 (51%) confirmed completing the annual procurement data quality report. Of the other 34, 23 said they did not complete one and 11 did not respond. The 34 held almost $2 billion, about 0.26% of FY2023 contract obligations. *Source GAO-25-107469, Highlights (PDF p. 2), p. 12 to 13 (PDF p. 17 to 18). Period covered is FY2023. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **F07.** The governmentwide Procurement Data Quality Summary that USAspending links is for FY2019. It reports a six-year weighted completeness of 96.2% and a six-year sample accuracy of 97.9% for CFO Act agencies, FY2014 to FY2019. It says most late actions came from entry issues or unfinished drafts. *Source FPDS-DQ-SUMMARY-FY2019, p. 1 (PDF p. 1), section C.a. Period covered is FY2014 to FY2019. Effect on the measure is timing.*
- **F08.** The only Procurement Data Quality Summary offered on the GSA Federal Service Desk page that USAspending links is the FY2019 edition. No later governmentwide summary is posted there. *Source FSD-KB0048871, FSD knowledge article KB0048871, article body. Period covered is FY2020 to FY2025 not posted. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **F14.** The OFPP certification template asks agencies to certify what percent of reportable actions are in FPDS, and to explain missing data by number, dollar value and age. *Source OFPP-2009-10-07, Exhibit 1, Part I (PDF p. 3). Period covered is FY2009 data on. Effect on the measure is scope.*

- **F15.** The 2009 OFPP template notes that transactions from non-appropriated funds should not be reported to FPDS unless approved by the GSA FPDS Program Office. *Source OFPP-2009-10-07, Exhibit 1, Part III, Scope of Review (PDF p. 6). Period covered is FY2009 data on. Effect on the measure is scope.*
- **F25.** OFPP in 2007 required statistically valid, independent verification of FPDS data and said the government had struggled to get contract data right for decades. *Source OFPP-2007-03-09, p. 2 (PDF p. 2). Period covered is FY2007 data on. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **F26.** OFPP required data quality plans for FY2008 FPDS data and a certification by January 5, 2009 that FY2008 data were in FPDS. *Source OFPP-2008-05-09, p. 2 (PDF p. 2). Period covered is FY2008. Effect on the measure is counts only.*
- **F27.** DoD components send their annual certification and data validation results for the prior fiscal year to DPC by December 15. DPC sends one consolidated DoD certification to OMB by January 5. *Source DFARS-204.6, DFARS 204.604(3). Period covered is Annual. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **F28.** OFPP's 2011 guidance kept annual certification each January of the prior fiscal year's FPDS records to OFPP and GSA. *Source OFPP-2011-05-31, p. 1 (PDF p. 1). Period covered is FY2011 data on. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **F29.** M-15-12 says procurement data sent to USAspending from FPDS follow existing FAR reporting and annual verification rules, and any change to FPDS reporting goes through rulemaking. *Source M-15-12, p. 5 (PDF p. 5). Period covered is 2015-05-08 on. Effect on the measure is already handled.*

Systems and validation. What Treasury and FPDS validate, and the state of the systems behind the data.

- **E30.** GAO reported that Treasury fixed broker errors for procurement fields found by inspectors general, including how FPDS-NG data map to File D1, and loaded previously missing historical procurement data to USAspending.gov by April 2018. *Source GAO-18-546, p. 20 (PDF p. 25). Period covered is FY2017 Q2 data, fixes reported April 2018. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **F01.** GAO found that Treasury does not validate award fields it imports from external systems such as FPDS and did not disclose this. GAO found procurement records whose start date fell after the end date and almost 8,000 procurement records with meaningless award descriptions. *Source GAO-22-104702, p. 23 (PDF p. 29). Period covered is Award records in the USAspending.gov database, reviewed for the period ending March 31, 2021. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **F02.** USAspending says it relies on the internal validations of FPDS and SAM.gov. Data extracted from these systems may not always align with OMB and Treasury data standards. *Source USAS-ATD-data-validation-of-source-systems, About the Data, "Data Validation of Source Systems", paragraph 2. Period covered is ongoing. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **F03.** GAO reported that award and subaward data the broker pulls from FPDS-NG, SAM, ASP and FSRS are not subject to any validations in the broker, unlike the files agencies submit from their financial systems. *Source GAO-18-138, p. 12 (PDF p. 17). Period covered is FY2017 Q2. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **F04.** GSA paused IAE modernization in September 2023 for lack of resources. In FY2023, IAE operating cost was about $168 million against agency contributions of about $68 million, a gap of nearly $100 million. FPDS is one of three legacy systems with no modernization plan. *Source GAO-25-107469, p. 30 to 31 (PDF p. 35 to 36). Period covered is FY2023 to May 2025. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **F24.** OMB in 2004 said GAO had found FPDS data not timely or accurate, and asked agencies to connect contract writing systems to FPDS-NG by the end of FY2005. *Source OMB-DDM-2004-08-25, p. 1 (PDF p. 1). Period covered is FY2004 to FY2005 (sets up FY2008). Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **F33.** In 2005 GAO found that DoD had delayed connecting its contract writing systems to FPDS-NG at least twice. DoD then held about 60 percent of FPDS-NG contract actions and expected full connection only in FY2006. *Source GAO-05-960R, p. 3 (PDF p. 3). Period covered is FY2004 to FY2005 (pre-FY2008). Effect on*

the measure is unknown.

- **F35.** GAO recommended that GSA add FPDS-NG controls so contract values are recorded accurately. GSA officials said no contract award should ever have a value of zero. *Source GAO-13-118, p. 12 (PDF p. 16) and Highlights (PDF p. 2). Period covered is 2012. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **F36.** FPDS-NG let contracting officers enter a competition code on single-award orders that differed from the parent contract. DHS said GSA expected to prefill these codes in FY2019 Q1, which would not fix multiple-award order errors. *Source GAO-19-63, p. 15 (PDF p. 20) and p. 16 (PDF p. 21). Period covered is FY2016 sample, system change expected FY2019 Q1. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **F38.** USAspending names FPDS as the authoritative source when procurement data disagree, and points users to the OMB Federal Government Procurement Data Quality Summary. *Source USAS-ABOUT-DATA-QUALITY, usaspending.gov/about, Data Quality section, paragraph after "Data Validation". Period covered is ongoing. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **F39.** USAspending fixed a bug in March 2022 that had shown several awards for one award ID in Advanced Search. It said transactions were unaffected. *Source USAS-RELEASE-NOTES-WIKI, Release notes, March 22nd, 2022, Bug Fixes, "Duplicate Awards". Period covered is fixed March 2022. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **F40.** GSA's FPDS help page on reportable actions still shows the 2008 version of FAR 4.606, with interagency agreements and resale on the optional list. The current FAR bars them. *Source FPDS-reportable-nonreportable, FPDS Help, Reportable/Nonreportable Contract Actions, 4.606(b)(8). Period covered is Page undated. Text matches the 2008 to 2012 rule. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **G17.** GSA put its work on plans to modernize FPDS and the other remaining legacy systems on hold by May 2025. OMB had not issued its procurement data quality summary for FY2023 or FY2024 by May 5, 2025. *Source GAO-25-107469, p. 32 (PDF p. 37), footnote 47 on p. 25 (PDF p. 30). Period covered is 2025. Effect on the measure is unknown.*

Warnings about using the data. What GAO, CRS and USAspending tell users about the data's limits.

- **D24.** GAO said in 2003 that many FPDS errors come from data entry mistakes by agency contracting staff. It also found FPDS coded 1,034 contracts worth $325 million as HUBZone awards to firms SBA had not certified, and missed 1,712 HUBZone contracts worth $589 million. *Source GAO-04-295R, p. 2 (PDF p. 2). Period covered is HUBZone review published 2001 (pre-FY2008). Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **E07.** GAO found that Treasury does not tell users that the completeness and comparability of award data vary across years because standards, requirements, validations and reviews changed. Users can pull FY2008 to FY2021 data with no note on how quality differs. *Source GAO-22-104702, p. 30 (PDF p. 36). Period covered is FY2008 to FY2021 award data. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **E08.** USAspending warns that reporting requirements change over time and that more recent fiscal years tend to have higher quality data. OMB guidance issued since 2010 changes the completeness and consistency of specific elements over time. *Source USAS-ATD-changes-in-reporting-requirements, About the Data, "Changes in Reporting Requirements", paragraph 1. Period covered is FY2001 onward. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **F23.** GAO said in 2005 that GSA had not told users how accurate and complete agency data in FPDS-NG were. In 2009 GAO said this information was still not readily available on the FPDS-NG website. *Source GAO-09-1032T, p. 4 (PDF p. 6), footnote 10. Period covered is 2005 and 2009. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **F31.** CRS warns that FPDS data may be unreliable and that a query can return different results depending on parameters and timing. CRS uses FPDS only for broad trends and rough estimates. *Source R44010, Summary (PDF p. 2). Period covered is Stated 2018. Effect on the measure is unknown.*

- **F32.** CRS says USAspending results may be incomplete or contain inaccuracies and points to GAO findings through September 2025. *Source R44027, p. 2 (PDF p. 5). Period covered is Stated 2026-05-21. Effect on the measure is unknown.*

Topic 6. Rule changes that move row counts

Changes to what must be reported, which create steps in row counts with little effect on dollars. This topic holds 15 findings.

Reporting rules, 2008 to 2012. The 2008 rewrite of FAR subpart 4.6 and the changes that followed.

- **E19.** The FAR rules for FPDS reporting were rewritten by an interim rule effective April 22, 2008, in the middle of FY2008. It defined contract actions and encouraged FAR-exempt agencies and non-appropriated fund buyers to report. *Source FR-2008-E8-8447, 73 FR 21774 (PDF p. 2). Period covered is FY2008 Q3. Effect on the measure is counts only.*
- **E20.** Under the 2008 rule, the list of optional actions included micro-purchases, non-appropriated funds, leases, resale, concessions, training, grants, interagency agreements and A-76 letters. Agencies had only to contact the FPDS Program Office. *Source FR-2008-E8-8447, FAR 4.606(b) as amended, 73 FR 21778 (PDF p. 6). Period covered is 2008-04-22 to 2012-12-19. Effect on the measure is counts only.*
- **E21.** The 2008 rule also required agencies in the Small Business Competitiveness Demonstration Program to report every award in the designated industry groups regardless of dollar value. A final rule effective January 31, 2011 removed that paragraph. *Source FR-2008-E8-8447, FAR 4.606(a)(2) as amended, 73 FR 21778 (PDF p. 6). Period covered is 2008-04-22 to about FY2011. Effect on the measure is counts only.*
- **E22.** The final rule that removed the Small Business Competitiveness Demonstration Program deleted FAR 4.606(a)(2) and renumbered the rest. *Source FR-2010-32900, 75 FR 82567 (PDF p. 1). Period covered is FY2011. Effect on the measure is counts only.*
- **E23.** DoD began requiring that purchase card buys under schedules, agreements or contracts be reported regardless of value in its PGI revised September 20, 2011. The August 16, 2010 revision had no such paragraph. *Source PGI-204.6-2011-09-20, PGI 204.606(5)(ii) (Revised September 20, 2011). Period covered is From 2011-09-20 (end of FY2011). Effect on the measure is counts only.*
- **E24.** The August 16, 2010 PGI listed four uses of express reporting, with item (3) for Defense Energy Support Center energy buys. The GPC delivery order use was added later. *Source PGI-204.6-2011-09-16, PGI 204.606(1)(iii)(A)(3) (Revised August 16, 2010). Period covered is PGI in force from 2010-08-16 to 2011-09-19. Effect on the measure is counts only.*
- **E25.** The DARS publication notice of September 20, 2011 lists PGI 204.6 changes that revise guidance on reporting contract actions to FPDS. *Source DARS-change-notices-2011, Publication Notice 20110920, PGI changes. Period covered is 2011-09-20. Effect on the measure is counts only.*
- **E26.** FAC 2005-62, effective December 20, 2012, moved resale, concessions, training expenditures, interagency agreements and A-76 letters from optional to not reported. It also required segregation and written approval for any optional reporting. *Source FAC-2005-62, FAC 2005-62, amendment 6 to FAR 4.606. Period covered is FY2013 Q1 on. Effect on the measure is counts only.*
- **E27.** FAC 2005-62 also says non-appropriated fund awards will generally not be in FPDS. The FAC 2005-25 text in 2008 had encouraged reporting them. *Source FAC-2005-62, FAC 2005-62, summary of Item I. Period covered is FY2013 on. Effect on the measure is counts only.*

How DoD records agreements and accounts. DoD reporting practices that change what a row stands for.

- **E43.** DoD reported BOAs and BPAs as indefinite delivery contracts in FPDS before FY2010. Calls under those older BPAs are reported as task or delivery orders. *Source PGI-204.6, PGI 204.606(3)(i). Period covered is FY2009 and earlier. Effect on the measure is already handled.*
- **E44.** Treasury Account Symbol fields stopped being required in FPDS in July 2016 and should be left blank. *Source PGI-204.6, PGI 204.606(3)(iv)(A). Period covered is From July 2016. Effect on the measure is small.*

The FAR overhaul of 2025. The rewrite of the FAR, which moves the reporting rules to a new section.

- **G24.** GAO notes the FAR is being rewritten under the Revolutionary FAR Overhaul (Executive Order 14275, April 2025). GAO cites the pre-overhaul FAR (legacy) for FY2025 actions. *Source GAO-26-109096, Footnote 3, p. 1 (PDF p. 1). Period covered is FY2025 to FY2026. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **G25.** Under the Revolutionary FAR Overhaul, FAR subpart 4.6 becomes section 4.301. Optional reporting now needs written approval from OFPP, and the annual certification goes to OFPP within 120 days. *Source RFO-FAR-Part-4, RFO FAR 4.301(a)(2). Period covered is Model deviation 2025, adopted by agency class deviations from about August 2025. Effect on the measure is counts only.*
- **G26.** The RFO text keeps all eleven exclusions from FAR 4.606(c), including classified actions and interagency agreements, and raises the generic identifier limit for individuals abroad to $40,000. *Source RFO-FAR-Part-4, RFO FAR 4.301(a)(3)(vi). Period covered is 2025 on. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **G27.** GSA adopted the FAR Council's Part 4 model deviation on August 13, 2025. The memo says section 4.301 consolidates and streamlines the reporting rules of subpart 4.6. *Source RFO-2025-04, p. 3 (PDF p. 3). Period covered is FY2025 Q4 on. Effect on the measure is small.*

Topic 7. Timeliness, revisions and the move to SAM.gov

The timing of reports, corrections made afterwards, and recent changes to the systems that publish the data. This topic holds 37 findings.

DoD's 90-day hold. DoD and Army Corps of Engineers data are released 90 days after signing.

- **C03.** FPDS warns that it is a real-time database. New actions, modifications and corrections can change data for current and prior fiscal years. DoD data in FPDS is subject to a 90-day delay. *Source FPDS-DoD-data-availability, FPDS page "What's New, DoD Data Availability", paragraph 1. Period covered is ongoing. Effect on the measure is timing.*
- **C04.** GSA's FPDS page says DoD data in FPDS-NG are subject to a 90-day delay and that FPDS updates can change data for current and prior fiscal years. *Source FPDS-DoD-data-availability, FPDS DoD Data Availability page. Period covered is Undated page, cited by CRS in 2019. Effect on the measure is timing.*
- **C06.** The written authority for DoD's 90-day delay is DFARS PGI 204.604(2). It says DoD contract action reports are not public or open to non-DoD use until 90 days after the Date Signed, to limit risk to military operations. *Source PGI-204.6, PGI 204.604(2). Period covered is Current PGI. Present in the PGI revised 2016-09-23. Effect on the measure is timing.*
- **C07.** DoD told its Inspector General in 2017 that the 90-day delay had been in place for over 10 years, with OMB and Treasury knowledge, and was documented on the FPDS website. *Source DODIG-2018-020, p. 18 (PDF p. 28). Period covered is About FY2007 to FY2017. Effect on the measure is timing.*
- **C08.** GAO reported that FPDS-NG releases DoD procurement data to the public only after a 90-day wait, so DoD contract data reach Beta.USAspending.gov 90 days late. DoD typically accounts for about two-thirds of federal contracting activity. Treasury did not disclose this limitation on the site. *Source GAO-18-138, p. 36 (PDF p. 41). Period covered is FY2017 Q2 (ongoing practice). Effect on the measure is timing.*

- **C09.** USAspending says DoD and USACE contract and IDV data are published on a 90-day delay in FPDS itself. The delay carries into USAspending Files C and D1 for these agencies. *Source USAS-ATD-delay-in-dod-procurement-data, About the Data, Sitewide Award Data Disclosures, "Delay in Department of Defense (DOD) Procurement Data", paragraph 1. Period covered is ongoing (disclosure live in September 2026). Effect on the measure is timing.*
- **C10.** The About page Data Quality section repeats the 90-day DoD and USACE delay and says it also delays File C and subcontract data. It says the disclosure was added because GAO identified the need. *Source USAS-ABOUT-DATA-QUALITY, usaspending.gov/about, Data Quality section, first bullet under "The Government Accountability Office (GAO) has identified the need to disclose the following two items". Period covered is ongoing. Effect on the measure is timing.*
- **C11.** GAO again found that the 90-day delay for DoD procurement data was not clearly communicated on USAspending.gov. DoD noted it only in its senior accountable official statement. Its agency profile and transaction queries did not show it. *Source GAO-20-75, p. 30 (PDF p. 36). Period covered is FY2018 Q4. Effect on the measure is timing.*
- **C12.** GAO reported that Treasury, in response to GAO-20-75, added disclosures about the 90-day delay for DoD procurement data on several USAspending.gov pages. *Source GAO-22-104702, p. 29 (PDF p. 35). Period covered is Status as of November 2021. Effect on the measure is timing.*
- **C13.** The FPDS public welcome text says DoD releases contract data only after a 90-day waiting period for security reasons. The same contracts count at once in FPDS aggregate Standard Reports. *Source FPDS-WELCOME, FPDS welcome text, section "What's in FPDS-NG?", item "Release of Data". Period covered is page dated 2011, still served 2026. Effect on the measure is timing.*
- **C14.** The 90-day sentence is not in PGI 204.604 as revised July 31, 2014. It is in PGI 204.604(2) as revised September 23, 2016. So the PGI text that authorizes the delay dates from 2015 or 2016. *Source PGI-204.6-2016-10-21, PGI 204.604(2) (Revised September 23, 2016). Period covered is 2014 to 2016. Effect on the measure is timing.*
- **C15.** In the PGI revised July 31, 2014, PGI 204.604 is a single unnumbered paragraph on the OSD Procurement Data Improvement Plan. It has no sentence on a 90-day release delay. *Source PGI-204.6-2014-11-05, PGI 204.604 (Revised July 31, 2014). Period covered is PGI in force 2014-07-31 until a later revision. Effect on the measure is timing.*
- **C16.** CRS says agencies must report award transactions within 30 days, and DoD data may lag longer, generally 90 days. *Source R44027, p. 3 (PDF p. 6). Period covered is Stated 2026-05-21. Effect on the measure is timing.*
- **C17.** For FY2017 Q2, DoD certified procurement award data for only one day, January 1, 2017. DoD procurement data were not public in FPDS until 91 days after award. *Source DODIG-2018-020, p. 6 (PDF p. 16). Period covered is FY2017 Q2. Effect on the measure is timing.*

Reporting deadlines and late entry. The FAR deadline for reports and how often agencies miss it.

- **C18.** DoD OIG found 11,248 untimely data elements in the FY2019 Q1 sample, across 81 of the 385 File D1 transactions. The DoD SAO said DATA Act data come from many systems at different frequencies. *Source DODIG-2020-010, p. 13 (PDF p. 21). Period covered is FY2019 Q1. Effect on the measure is timing.*
- **C19.** DoD entered many contract actions into FPDS-NG later than the FAR deadline of 3 business days after signing. This made 2,083 File D1 data elements untimely. *Source DODIG-2022-027, p. 15 (PDF p. 25). Period covered is FY2020 Q4. Effect on the measure is timing.*
- **C20.** NASA entered 22 sampled procurement actions into FPDS-NG late. The delayed awards were entered an average of 60 days after the 3-day FAR deadline. *Source IG-22-002, p. 14 (PDF p. 20). Period covered is FY2020 Q4. Effect on the measure is timing.*

- **C21.** GSA OIG found 7 sampled File C records that were missing from File D1. Four were late FPDS-NG entries and three had a mistyped award ID. *Source A210023/B/R/F22001, p. 6 (PDF p. 10). Period covered is FY2021 Q1. Effect on the measure is timing.*
- **C22.** Contract data usually reach USAspending within five days. Contracting officers have three business days to report to FPDS. Two exceptions are the DoD and USACE 90-day delay and a 30-day window for unusual and compelling urgency awards and for actions under FAR subpart 18.2. *Source USAS-ATD-frequency-of-updates-to-prime-award-data-for-contracts, About the Data, "Frequency of Updates to Prime Award Data for Contracts (Procurement)", exceptions list. Period covered is ongoing. Effect on the measure is timing.*
- **C23.** FAR 4.604(b) sets the deadline for a complete contract action report at three business days after award, or 30 days for urgency awards and emergency acquisitions. Reports in draft or error status are not complete. *Source FAR-4.6, FAR 4.604(b)(1) to (b)(3). Period covered is Current FAR. Same deadlines in the 2012 rule. Effect on the measure is timing.*
- **C24.** The same clarification says urgent and emergency awards can reach the financial system before FPDS, and emergency flexibilities can delay or waive reporting requirements. *Source OMB-OFPP-clarifying-proc-data, p. 5 (PDF p. 5). Period covered is Undated (created 2021-01-04). Effect on the measure is timing.*
- **C25.** Treasury officials told GAO that data published in FPDS take 2 days to appear on USAspending.gov. *Source GAO-22-104702, p. 7 (PDF p. 13). Period covered is 2021 and later. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **C26.** File D1 data come to USAspending two days after an action is submitted to FPDS. *Source USAS-ATD-file-d1, About the Data, "File D1 (Award and Awardee Attributes (Procurement))", paragraph 2. Period covered is ongoing. Effect on the measure is small.*

Changes after the fact and published totals. Corrections with no cut-off, and the dates behind GAO's totals.

- **C01.** OFPP's FAQ says FPDS has no cut-off date for adding, deleting, changing or fixing an action, and agencies can amend active contracts back to 1980. *Source OMB-OFPP-pro-data-FAQ, Question 2. Period covered is Undated archived FAQ. Effect on the measure is timing.*
- **C05.** GAO's yearly contracting snapshots use FPDS data pulled six to nine months after the fiscal year ends. The dashboards cite FPDS data as of May 2023 for FY2022, May 2024 for FY2023, June 2025 for FY2024 and April 2026 for FY2025. The FY2018 to FY2020 infographics cite FPDS-NG data for the year with no extraction date. *Source GAO-DASHBOARD-FY2024-DATA, textData.sourceDate. Period covered is FY2018 to FY2025. Effect on the measure is timing.*
- **D88.** The FY2024 and FY2025 dashboards drop missing or other values from their figures. GAO says these values are less than one percent of total obligations. *Source GAO-DASHBOARD-FY2024-DATA, textData.NaN. Period covered is FY2024 to FY2025. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **E31.** GAO's snapshot totals include COVID-19 spending. FY2022 obligations were $694 billion including about $40 billion related to COVID-19. GAO reports year-over-year changes after adjusting for inflation. *Source GAO-DASHBOARD-FY2022-DATA, textData.intro. Period covered is FY2020 to FY2022. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **G20.** GAO reports federal contract obligations of $792.77 billion in FY2025 and $756.18 billion in FY2024, from USAspending data as of April 2026. *Source GAO-26-108615, Table 1, p. 6 (PDF p. 10). Period covered is FY2024 to FY2025. Effect on the measure is unknown.*

The move to SAM.gov and the 2025 funding lapse. The replacement of FPDS by SAM.gov in 2026 and the fall 2025 lapse.

- **G05.** GAO reports that SAM.gov replaced FPDS as the government repository for procurement data on February 24, 2026. *Source GAO-26-109096, How GAO Did This Study, footnote 28, p. 11 (PDF p. 11). Period covered is From FY2026 Q2. Effect on the measure is unknown.*

- **G06.** SAM.gov states that all FPDS.gov contract award data is now in SAM.gov and that ezSearch was decommissioned on February 24, 2026. Agencies now report through the SAM Contract Awards Management portal, the former FPDS database. The ATOM feed is being replaced by a SAM.gov Contract Awards API that adds deleted contracts. *Source SAM-FPDS-page, Legacy Website and Atom Feed sections. Period covered is 2026. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **G07.** GSA retired FPDS.gov ezSearch on February 24, 2026 and moved all public FPDS functions into SAM.gov. Agency contract writing systems keep reporting through the SAM Contract Awards Management portal, which GSA calls the former FPDS database. *Source SAM-FPDS, sam.gov/fpds, section "Manage Contract Award Data". Period covered is FY2026. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **G08.** CRS now says SAM.gov is the source of contract award data in USAspending, and that contract award data previously came from FPDS. *Source R44027, p. 6, footnote 16 (PDF p. 9). Period covered is Stated 2026-05-21. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **G09.** The Broker release of September 22, 2026 mentions an upcoming SAM Contract loader. This points to a new contract data feed into the Broker. *Source BROKER-REL-226.0, body, technical changes list, item 1. Period covered is September 2026. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **G10.** GSA says the FPDS ATOM feed will be retired later in FY2026 and replaced by the SAM.gov Contract Awards API. *Source SAM-ANNOUNCE-FPDS-SEARCH-2026, SAM.gov announcement, body. Period covered is FY2026. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **G18.** The fall 2025 lapse in appropriations lasted 42 days, from October 1 through November 11, 2025. P.L. 119-37, signed November 12, 2025, ended it. *Source R48765, Summary (PDF p. 2). Period covered is FY2026 Q1. Effect on the measure is timing.*
- **G19.** The GSA lapse plan says activities of the Federal Acquisition Service that are funded through the Acquisition Services Fund are exempt from the lapse. The plan does not name FPDS, SAM.gov or the Integrated Award Environment. *Source GSA-Lapse-Plan-2025, Para. 4.o(1), Federal Acquisition Service, p. 17 (PDF p. 17). Period covered is October 1 to November 11, 2025. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **G29.** GSA notes that NASA award data may be obtained from the SAM Data Bank, apart from the general contract award search. *Source SAM-FPDS, sam.gov/fpds, section "ezSearch", last line. Period covered is 2026. Effect on the measure is unknown.*

Topic 8. Deobligations and terminations

How returned money and ended contracts appear in the data, including the FY2025 terminations. This topic holds 13 findings.

How deobligations are recorded. The sign convention and deobligations that never reach File D1.

- **C02.** The acquisition.gov clarification says some simple fixed-price actions can be deobligated after the final invoice without a contract modification. That deobligation shows in File C with no File D1 record. *Source OMB-OFPP-clarifying-proc-data, p. 3 (PDF p. 3). Period covered is Undated (created 2021-01-04). Applies to DATA Act files from FY2017 on. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **D59.** The FPDS Action Obligation element records the net amount obligated or de-obligated by each transaction. De-obligations carry a minus sign. *Source FPDS-DD-V1.5, Element 3C Action Obligation, Instruction, p. 39 (PDF p. 41). Period covered is all years. Effect on the measure is already handled.*
- **G30.** FAR 4.606(a)(1) requires agencies to report any modification that changes previously reported contract action data, regardless of dollar value. Termination modifications therefore must be reported to FPDS. *Source FAR-4.6, FAR 4.606(a)(1). Period covered is FY2008 to FY2025. Effect on the measure is already handled.*

- **G31.** DoD guidance requires a modification report for any obligation or deobligation and a minus sign for a net deobligation. Terminations for default or cause must also be reported to FAPIIS. *Source PGI-204.6, PGI 204.606(3)(vi)(A). Period covered is FY2008 to FY2025. Effect on the measure is already handled.*
- **G32.** The FPDS data element Reason for Modification, published by USAspending as action_type, has separate codes for terminations. E is terminate for default, F is terminate for convenience, X is terminate for cause and N is legal contract cancellation. *Source USAS-DATA-DICTIONARY, document.rows[9] (ActionType), Domain Values. Period covered is FY2008 to FY2025. Effect on the measure is already handled.*

Terminations in FY2025. Contract terminations across agencies in 2025 and how fully FPDS records them.

- **G04.** State officials told GAO that several thousand USAID contracts were never updated in FPDS to show the termination, because of the USAID reduction in force. *Source GAO-26-108615, Figure 3 notes, p. 18 (PDF p. 22). Period covered is FY2025. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **G11.** FPDS records a termination but does not say whether it was complete or partial. GAO adds that an undetermined part of the terminated contracts is still active. *Source GAO-26-108615, Footnote 39, p. 17 (PDF p. 21). Period covered is FY2025 to FY2026. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **G12.** USDA contracting systems code every termination for convenience as one value that covers complete and partial terminations. The systems cannot tell the two apart. *Source 50601-0012-31, Footnote 2, p. 1 (PDF p. 5), repeated in footnote 7, p. 3 (PDF p. 7). Period covered is FY2025. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **G13.** USDA terminated 792 contracts for convenience in FY2025. Net deobligations reached $64.4 million by March 20, 2026, and vendors have up to one year to file settlement proposals. *Source 50601-0012-31, Overall Conclusion, p. 3 (PDF p. 7). Period covered is FY2025 to FY2026. Effect on the measure is timing.*
- **G14.** Savings figures for terminated contracts ignore later obligations and deobligations from settlement costs and closeout. GAO concludes the reported savings are likely misstated. *Source GAO-26-108615, p. 20 (PDF p. 24). Period covered is FY2025 to FY2027. Effect on the measure is timing.*
- **G21.** DOGE listed 13,476 contracts as terminated, but FPDS shows no termination action on 2,503 of them. Those 2,503 carry $27.4 billion of the claimed savings. *Source GAO-26-108615, p. 18 (PDF p. 22). Period covered is January 20, 2025 to July 7, 2026. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **G22.** DHS fully or partially terminated 438 contracts from January 20 through September 30, 2025. DHS had obligated over $1.6 billion on them before termination and deobligated a net $92 million since. *Source GAO-26-109096, Key Takeaways, p. 2 (PDF p. 2). Period covered is January 20 to September 30, 2025. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **G23.** VA terminated 435 contract actions for convenience in 2025, valued at about $1.1 billion, out of 2,210 actions the OIG reviewed. Lists VA sent to Congress were wrong, and some actions were terminated and then reinstated. *Source 25-03033-230, Executive Summary, p. ii (PDF p. 4). Period covered is January to June 2025 (FY2025). Effect on the measure is small.*

Topic 9. Links between awards and agency accounts

How contract records in FPDS link to agencies' own account data, and where the links fail. This topic holds 10 findings.

Linkage statistics. The counts USAspending publishes of awards that do not link.

- **E45.** DHS OIG measured how much DHS award obligations in File C failed to match Files D1 and D2 by award ID and amount. The misaligned share fell from 38 percent in FY2017 Q2 to 4 percent in FY2019 Q1 and 2 percent in FY2020 Q4. *Source OIG-22-04, p. 12 (PDF p. 15). Period covered is FY2017 Q2 to FY2020 Q4. Effect on the measure is unknown.*

- **F11.** The submission statistics table covers only the period since DATA Act reporting began in FY2017 Q2. The government publishes no linkage statistics for FY2008 to FY2016. *Source USAS-SUBMISSION-STATS-DSM, Data Sources and Methodology, section "Using this Table", paragraph 1. Period covered is FY2017 Q2 onward. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **F12.** The State Department shows 80,177 File C procurement awards with no FPDS match in FY2025 period 12, up from 1,356 in FY2023 period 12. Its linked procurement awards fell from 10,341 to 7,766. *Source USAS-UNLINKED-019-FY2025-P12, response key unlinked_file_c_award_count. Period covered is FY2023 P12 and FY2025 P12. Effect on the measure is scope.*
- **F17.** For FY2025 period 12 the government reports DoD with 436,163 unlinked contract awards. 27 are File C awards with no FPDS match and 436,136 are FPDS awards with no File C match. Only 25,729 DoD procurement awards are linked. *Source USAS-UNLINKED-097-FY2025-P12, response keys unlinked_file_c_award_count, unlinked_file_d_award_count, total_linked_award_count. Period covered is FY2025 P12 (as of 2026-10-06). Effect on the measure is small.*
- **F18.** Across all 111 agencies, the government reports 555,086 unlinked contract awards for FY2025 period 12. DoD (436,163), State (82,780), GSA (19,652) and VA (10,572) hold most of them. *Source USAS-REPORTING-OVERVIEW-FY2025-P12, results[].unlinked_contract_award_count (pages 1 and 2 summed). Period covered is FY2025 P12 (as of 2026-10-06). Effect on the measure is counts only.*
- **F19.** USAspending explains that award data come from two systems, agency financial systems (File C) and FPDS (File D1). Awards that do not share an award ID cannot be linked, and gaps between the two datasets are expected. *Source USAS-SUBMISSION-STATS-DSM, Agency Submission Statistics, Data Sources and Methodology, section "Number of Unlinked Awards", paragraph 1. Period covered is FY2017 Q2 onward. Effect on the measure is unknown.*
- **F20.** USAspending defines the unlinked contract count as File C procurement awards with no File D1 match plus File D1 awards with no File C match, each with activity in the selected period. The usaspending-api code adds the two counts. *Source USAS-API-OVERVIEW-CODE, overview.py, annotate block for unlinked_contract_award_count (lines 73 to 79). Period covered is FY2017 Q2 onward. Effect on the measure is counts only.*
- **F21.** GAO found that over 10 million award records totaling over $1.2 trillion in obligations were not linked to financial data for FY2020 to FY2022. Unlinked award records lack account, program activity and disaster codes. *Source GAO-24-106214, p. 8 (PDF p. 8). Period covered is FY2020 to FY2022. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **F22.** For Q4 FY2018, DoD's File C included data from only 6 of its 18 accounting systems, about $2.2 billion of the $117 billion in its Files D1 and D2. *Source GAO-20-75, p. 11 (PDF p. 17). Period covered is FY2018 Q4. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **G16.** DoD File C to File D1 linkage fell sharply in FY2024 and FY2025. Linked DoD procurement awards were 944,252 in FY2019 P12 and 554,163 in FY2023 P12, then 137,180 in FY2024 P12, 28,962 in FY2025 P6 and 25,729 in FY2025 P12. Unlinked FPDS awards rose from 50,295 to 436,136. *Source USAS-UNLINKED-097-FY2024-P12, response keys unlinked_file_d_award_count, total_linked_award_count (FY2024 P12). Other years in sources USAS-UNLINKED-097-FY2018-P12 to USAS-UNLINKED-097-FY2025-P12. Period covered is FY2018 P12 to FY2025 P12. Effect on the measure is small.*

Topic 10. Other fields

Fields our measure does not use directly, which matter for side analyses. This topic holds 34 findings.

Dollar and contract value fields. Obligation amounts and the value fields that FPDS calculates.

- **D45.** DoD reported Federal Action Obligation correctly on most sampled contract transactions. The sample error rate was 3.0 percent (11 of 369), with an absolute error of $27.5 million in the sample. *Source DODIG-2022-027, p. 43 (PDF p. 53), Table 6. Period covered is FY2020 Q4. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **D54.** DOE's Current Total Value and Potential Total Value of Award fields in FPDS did not match agency records on 114 and 136 records. DOE linked this to FPDS errors made before the DATA Act and carried forward on management and operating contracts. *Source DOE-OIG-22-03, p. 5 (PDF p. 9). Period covered is FY2021 Q1. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **D55.** NASA contracting officers followed the FPDS-NG definition of Current Total Value of Award, which differs from the DATA Act definition. Errors hit 85 sampled File D1 transactions worth $4 billion. *Source IG-22-002, p. 15 (PDF p. 21). Period covered is FY2020 Q4. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **D56.** OIGs reported Current Total Value and Potential Total Value errors caused by known calculation issues within FPDS. *Source GAO-22-105427, p. 18 (PDF p. 24). Period covered is Mostly FY2020 Q4 or FY2021 Q1. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **D57.** For Q1 FY2019, 27 OIGs reported errors in Federal Action Obligation on procurement awards, totaling about $84 million in absolute value. The largest dollar errors were in Potential Total Value of Award, about $384 billion. *Source GAO-20-540, p. 17 (PDF p. 23), Table 1 on p. 18 (PDF p. 24). Period covered is FY2019 Q1. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **D58.** One OIG found its agency misused the Transaction Obligated Amount standard to report deobligations. Fifteen OIGs reported procurement Federal Action Obligation errors totaling about $64 million in absolute value. *Source GAO-22-105427, p. 18 (PDF p. 24). Period covered is FY2020 Q3 to FY2021 Q2. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **D74.** GAO found the FPDS-NG base and all options value reported far below the true contract value in several cases, and five contracts since October 28, 2009, listed with a value of zero. One Army contract worth about $84 million was reported at $24 million, and two related Army contracts listed at zero were worth $350 million. *Source GAO-13-118, p. 11 (PDF p. 15) and p. 12 (PDF p. 16). Period covered is FY2008 to March 31, 2012 (FY2012 Q2). Effect on the measure is small.*
- **D83.** DoD put Federal Action Obligation amounts into the Current Total Value and Potential Total Value fields in FPDS for FY2017 Q2. *Source DODIG-2018-020, p. 14 (PDF p. 24). Period covered is FY2017 Q2. Effect on the measure is small.*

Competition and offers. Competition codes and the number of offers received.

- **D60.** GAO compared FPDS-NG competition coding with contract files for 107 contracts and orders and found 19 coded incorrectly, about 18 percent. Nine coded as not competed had been competed, and 10 coded as competed with one offer were either not competed or had more than one offer. *Source GAO-10-833, p. 12 (PDF p. 17), Table 1. Period covered is Contracts at locations chosen on FY2008 obligations. Trend data FY2005 to FY2009. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **D61.** Five of the nine contracts wrongly coded as not competed were orders under single-award IDIQ contracts that had been competed. The orders were coded as not competed. *Source GAO-10-833, p. 12 (PDF p. 17). Period covered is Same sample as above. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **D62.** GAO checked 35 high-dollar DoD awards coded in FPDS-NG as competed with one offer and found 10 coded wrongly, worth $271.8 million. Six were noncompetitive awards and four had received multiple offers. GAO judged DoD's one-offer data not sufficiently reliable. *Source GAO-13-325, p. 26 (PDF p. 30). Period covered is Awards issued April 1, 2011, to March 31, 2012 (FY2011 Q3 to FY2012 Q2). DoD IG sample FY2011. Effect on the measure is small.*

- **D63.** GAO said its sample covered large-dollar awards that get more review, so errors may be more common among other awards. GAO still found DoD competition data reliable enough for overall trend analysis. *Source GAO-13-325, p. 30 (PDF p. 34). Period covered is FY2008 to FY2012 trend data. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **D64.** GAO found 28 of 62 sampled contracts coded in FPDS-NG as noncompetitive under the urgency exception when they were not. Twenty of the 28 had used simplified acquisition procedures instead. *Source GAO-14-304, Highlights (PDF p. 2) and p. 11 (PDF p. 16). Period covered is FY2011 to FY2012 sample. FY2010 to FY2012 trends. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **D65.** GAO found DoD, DHS and HHS misreported competition data in FPDS-NG for 22 of 41 IT orders it reviewed. Most were competed orders coded with an exception to fair opportunity, which put competition data on about $3 billion a year of IT orders in doubt. *Source GAO-19-63, Highlights (PDF p. 2) and p. 14 (PDF p. 19). Period covered is FY2016 sample. FY2013 to FY2017 trends. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **D66.** Between $10 million and $148 million a year of IT obligations in FPDS-NG carried no competition code at all. *Source GAO-19-63, p. 14 (PDF p. 19), Figure 3 note. Period covered is FY2013 to FY2017. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **D67.** FPDS-NG records only whether the base OT awarded to a consortium was competed. Modifications that fund consortium projects keep the base award's competition code, even when the projects were competed among members. *Source GAO-20-84, p. 16 (PDF p. 20). Period covered is FY2016 to FY2018. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **E28.** FPDS Version 1.5 added IDV Number of Offers Received and a Number of Offers Received Source element. The V1.5 change log starts on 10/20/2016. *Source FPDS-SPEC-V1.5-CHANGES, Background list, p. 1 (PDF p. 5). Revision history, p. iii (PDF p. 4). Period covered is V1.5 rollout from late 2016 and 2017. Effect on the measure is bias risk.*
- **E29.** The FPDS dictionary says that for delivery orders and BPA calls under a single-award IDV, Number of Offers Received propagates only to the IDV Number of Offers element. Later revisions added Number of Offers Received Source (12/04/2023) and IDV Number of Offers Received (10/18/2025). *Source FPDS-DD-V1.5, Element 10D Number of Offers Received, Notes, p. 120 (PDF p. 122). Period covered is FY2024 to FY2026. Effect on the measure is small.*

COVID-19 and disaster codes. The national interest action code and the disaster emergency fund code.

- **D71.** GAO used the National Interest Action code to find COVID-19 contract actions but said some coded actions held obligations not specific to the pandemic. It removed such obligations for actions over $1 million. GAO also noted prior inconsistencies in how these codes were opened and closed after earlier disasters. *Source GAO-20-632, p. 11 (PDF p. 15) and pp. 2 to 3 (PDF pp. 6 to 7). Period covered is FY2020 (data as of June 11, 2020). Prior disaster review April 2019 (2017 hurricanes). Effect on the measure is small.*
- **D72.** GAO found in February 2021 that over $1.2 billion in USDA Farmers to Families Food Box obligations were not reported with the COVID-19 National Interest Action code. USDA later went back and coded the earlier actions. *Source GAO-21-387, p. 32 (PDF p. 48). Period covered is FY2020 to FY2021 (found February 2021). Effect on the measure is small.*
- **D73.** OMB required a Disaster Emergency Fund Code in financial files for contracts funded by COVID-19 supplemental money and a separate NIA code in FPDS-NG for all COVID-19 procurement actions. GAO said the two are not tied, so an award can carry one without the other, and USAspending's DEFC-based COVID-19 totals do not capture all COVID-19 procurement. *Source GAO-21-387, p. 411 (PDF p. 427), table note e. Period covered is FY2020 to FY2021. Effect on the measure is small.*

Small business and socioeconomic fields. Small business, minority-owned and waiver fields.

- **D75.** GAO estimated that NNSA and six of its M&O contractors wrongly reported $1.1 billion of $16.8 billion in small business awards in FY2018 to FY2022 as going to small businesses. For another $1.9 billion GAO could not tell whether the business was small. *Source GAO-25-106820, Highlights (PDF p. 2) and p. 10 (PDF p. 14). Period covered is FY2018 to FY2022. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **D77.** Minority-owned flags in FPDS-NG come from business owners' self-identification in CCR, which GAO could not independently verify. In FY2011 data, firms tagged with a specific minority group but not flagged as minority-owned made up less than 3 percent of cases. *Source GAO-12-873, p. 27 (PDF p. 32). Period covered is FY2011. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **D78.** FPDS has no field showing whether an approved nonmanufacturer rule waiver was used on a contract. GAO said this leaves no way to tell whether waivers helped agencies meet small business goals. *Source GAO-24-106196, p. 10 (PDF p. 14). Period covered is FY2017 to FY2022. Effect on the measure is small.*

Dates, places, types and descriptions. Other fields with documented problems.

- **D76.** In FY2015 the IDV type was missing for $0.06 billion of defense obligations and $0.3 billion of civilian obligations in FPDS-NG. *Source GAO-17-244SP, p. 22 (PDF p. 28), Table 2 note. Period covered is FY2015. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **D80.** Procurement committee officials told GAO that some agencies purposely changed dates in FPDS so that expired contracts would not appear active in service contract inventory reports. GAO said this leads to inaccurate FPDS data. *Source GAO-25-107469, p. 27 (PDF p. 32). Period covered is Reported during the March 2024 to September 2025 audit. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **D81.** GAO reported that some indefinite delivery contracts carried the wrong award type because the FPDS-NG data dictionary did not match the data feed the broker used. Treasury said it was building a workaround and could not change FPDS-NG itself. *Source GAO-18-138, p. 36 (PDF p. 41). Period covered is FY2017 Q2. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **D82.** DoD reported the vendor's own address as the primary place of performance on 232 of 385 sampled contract actions. DoD followed a DFARS PGI instruction that differs from the OMB and Treasury definition. *Source DODIG-2020-010, p. 12 (PDF p. 20). Period covered is FY2019 Q1. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **D84.** DHS described the reason for a modification, such as deobligating funds, in the award description instead of the goods or services bought. *Source OIG-22-04, p. 20 (PDF p. 23). Period covered is FY2020 Q4. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **D85.** DOE OIG found 314 procurement records missing Legal Entity Congressional District. The broker did not extract this field from FPDS-NG into File D1 as designed. *Source DOE-OIG-22-03, p. 4 (PDF p. 8). Period covered is FY2021 Q1. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **D87.** USAspending says award descriptions have been persistently hard for agencies to keep accurate. Some are too long, too technical, coded, or empty. *Source USAS-ATD-award-description-data-quality, About the Data, "Award Description Data Quality", paragraph 2. Period covered is all years. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **E39.** FPDS changed how it records period of performance start dates for actions dated on or after October 25, 2019. The date now carries from the base award to every modification. *Source USAS-RELEASE-NOTES-WIKI, Release notes, November 04, 2019, Data and Download Notes, "Prime Contract Data". Period covered is FY2020 onward. Effect on the measure is small.*
- **E40.** FPDS removed vendor Annual Revenue and Number of Employees from its public feed on October 26, 2018, after ruling them For Official Use Only. USAspending later dropped both columns from downloads. *Source USAS-RELEASE-NOTES-WIKI, Release notes, July 15, 2019, Data Notes. Period covered is FY2019 onward. Effect on the measure is small.*

- **E41.** From June 28, 2019 FPDS cut the maximum length of the award description from 4,000 to 250 characters for new contract awards. *Source USAS-RELEASE-NOTES-WIKI, Release notes, June 28, 2019, Data Notes. Period covered is June 2019 onward. Effect on the measure is small.*

Appendix C. Changes, files and sources

Changes after review

- **D06, the DoD parent ID result.** Version 1 read the 57 of 57 result as "a direct risk to vendor grouping in the earlier years". Table 3 of DODIG-2018-020 (report p. 22, PDF p. 32) shows the same 57 of 57 for Primary Place of Performance Country Code, Congressional District and Address, and for Type of Transaction Code. The table combines inaccurate and unsupported values, and footnote 1 says the parent ID is an FPDS-generated element. Version 2 treats the result as weak evidence about parent values. The row for D06 in `config/gov_findings.csv` is unchanged, because the findings file is shared with version 1.

Files

What	Location
This note	`docs/research/government_documented_gaps_v3.md`, `reports/research/government_documented_gaps_v3.pdf`
What changed from version 2	`docs/research/government_documented_gaps_v3_changes.md`
Version 2, frozen, the same body without the findings appendix	`docs/research/government_documented_gaps_v2.md`
Version 1, frozen, with the search log and the notes checked	`docs/research/government_documented_gaps.md`, `reports/research/government_documented_gaps.pdf`
The script that builds the findings appendix and source list	`tools/build_gaps_appendix.py`
One row per finding and per source	`config/gov_findings.csv`, `config/gov_sources.csv`
Saved copies of every source	`data/external/gov_sources/`
Agency renames	`docs/research/Agency_Name_Changes_USAspending.docx`

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